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WAR DIARY
or
INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY
(Erase heading not required.)

Army Form C. 2118

(3)

Place	Date 1916 MAY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
WIELTJE. Trenches in	10th		It should be mentioned that an offrm (Lt Rodakowski) was struck off all other duty in the trenches as Intelligence (or Sniping) offrm, & regular observation posts as well as Snipers were posted from this date. This was by Brigade order, some other Brigades having a Brigade offrm for this purpose, in some cases in addition to Batt. offrs. There was an immediate noticeable improvement in our Intelligence reports. A quiet morning, but no 1 was shelled with Whizzbangs & Shrapnel during the afternoon. 8 men being wounded. A large working party was to be employed on a new trench to join the 2 front companies, but was held up by M.G. fire. Special efforts were also made to improve our wire through the tour.	
	11th		A normal quiet day in trenches. 1 man wounded.	
	12th		After a quiet day, enemy started at 8.30 pm to bombard ST JEAN with 4'2 Shrapnel, & kept it up right through the night until 4-30 a.m. Considering that water parties were at Batt. H.Qrs before it started, & all got back safely, we were very lucky to avoid casualties. 2 men wounded during the day.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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Army Form C. 2118

4

Place	Date 1916 MAY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches near WIELTJE. YPRES	13th		A quiet day in the Trenches. 1 man wounded. Batn. was relieved during the latter part of the night by 2nd Bn. Grenadier Gds, & returned to former quarters in YPRES prison, magazine &c. just before daylight	
	14th		A quiet day: usual routine after coming out of trenches.	
	15th		Normal quiet day, & usual routine. 2 platoons digging at night.	
	16th		Moving after 11-0 pm, Batn. relieved 2nd Bn. Grenadiers in the same line: taking over just before daylight on No 4 holding Right front, No 2 Left front, No 1 in Support, 3 in Reserve.	
	17th		An even quieter day than usual, with no casualties.	
	18th		Was the first anniversary of one of the Battalion's bad days, but the line was again very quiet: but during the early hours the Germans made what was evidently an attempt to rush HORDERN POST, (G 28 b 3.6) — owing to the former's coolness and the latter's vigorous offensive action with rifle and bombs, the hostile party about 20 strong, fled. Lt Tisdall & No 4182 Pte Young A. came upon them unexpectedly, &	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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Army Form C. 2118

(5)

Place	Date 1916 MAY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches near WIELTJE.	19th		Some shelling on the Support line, no 1 coy being again unlucky - Bath was relieved during the night by 7th K.O. Yorkshire L.I. of 20th Division who came by rail & did not arrive much before midnight. Casualties during the day :- 7 men wounded.	
	20th	2-15 a.m.	On relief, the Companies marched to the Asylum siding at YPRES, thence by rail at 2-15 a.m. to a siding about a mile WEST of POPERINGHE where they bivouaced alongside the line : the weather being very warm - 1st Line Transport joined Bath there.	
LONGUENESSE.		10-0 a.m.	Entrained at the same siding, complete with Transport, for ST OMER. Arriving about 1-0 pm, marched about 3 miles to LONGUENESSE. The whole Bath. found good billets in one very large farm in the centre of the small village : officers mostly in neighbouring houses. Owing to bad Staff arrangements the 2nd Batt Coldstream had also unexpectedly to be accomodated, but there was ample room for both although the Coldstream were crowded - Bde HQ were in the neighbouring Chateau, & the other 3 Batts in villages near.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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Army Form C. 2118

(6)

Place	1916 Date MAY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LONGUENESSE	21st		Captain C. F. FLEMING joined the Batt: from leave, & took over command of no 2 Coy from Lt (temp Capt) A. C. W. Lines. Mass for 2 coys at a funktion in Church. Church of England party into 2nd Coldstream. Regarded as a period of rest, & taken up with refitting generally, also platoon drills & instruction for NCOs. The best of weather. Company Commanders were also taken by motor to a Stokes gun demonstration	
	22nd			
	23rd			
	24th			
	25th			
	26th			
	27th		Batt: Drill on the parade ground of the Cadet School at Blendecques, of which Lt J. Halligan (late ORs 10th Irish Bde) was Adjutant.	
	28th		Mass as on previous Sunday & Church of England service in the open. The 2nd Coldstream had moved to another village during the week. The Batt: football team played matches against the 9th H.L.I. and an ASC Coy in ST OMER, being badly beaten in the first & winning the second. The grant of the Military Cross to Lt TISDALL & the Distinguished Conduct Medal to No 4182 Pte A. YOUNG for their work on the night of the 17th/18th inst was announced in orders.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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Army Form C. 2118

(6)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LONGUENESSE	29th 30th 31st		Taken up by more strenuous training, including the digging of 4 lines of trenches some 3 miles distant, for assault practice purposes. There was also Company Drill on the Aviation ground close by	

R. McCalmont
Lt Col
Cmdg 1/ Bn. Irish Guards

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

1st BATTALION

IRISH GUARDS.

JUNE 1916

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Army Form C. 2118

1 Irish Guards (1)

Vol 23

Place	Date 1916 JUNE	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LONGUENESSE (St OMER)	1st		Company Drill & other Training. A large number of Photographic groups were taken.	
	2nd		Batt[n] practised the assault over the Trenches. Lt-Col R. McCalmont proceeded to London under orders, in connection with the situation in Ireland. Major T.M.D. Bailie assumed command.	
	3rd		After Company Drill in the morning, the afternoon was given up to a Boxing Entertainment given by the Batt[n], a ring being erected in a large field adjoining billets: CSM Voyles and other experienced boxers fought contests: there were some 60 or 70 officers of other units present, including the Major General, the Brigadier - There were about 2000 other ranks also present, including a large number of 12[th] Lancers who came with their Pte Young (beaten by CSM Voyles). In the Kings Birthday Honours list CSM Voyles received the DCM, mainly for his conduct on 18[th] May 1915. 47 officers attended an Old Etonian dinner in ST OMER, including 7 from the Batt[n]. 2nd Lieut F.H.N. LEE joined Batt[n] from Entrenching Batt[n].	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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WAR DIARY
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(Erase heading not required.)

Army Form C. 2118

(2)

Place	Date 1916 JUNE	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LONGUENESSE	4th =		Batn attended mass in the Cathedral at St Omer. Father Brown being on leave = Church of England service in billets.	
	5th =		Drill on the Aviation Ground. Some Batn Boxing Competitions were finished during the morning.	
	6th =		Batn had its final Assault practice over the trenches, in smoke helmets, and in pouring rain.	
Aug'K'. POPERINGHE HONDEGHEM	7th =	7.40 a.m. 2.0 p.m.	Marched to HONDEGHEM (about 12 miles), arriving there about to find but scattered billets = the other 3 Batns being close. A number of cases of sore-feet, believed due to a bad issue of socks.	Sheet 27. L 3d.
	8th =	7.10 am	Marched for 'K' camp, about 1½ miles NW of POPERINGHE — a distance of about 10 miles, a considerable distance for Brigade rendezvous.	
		11.30 am	Arrived in Camp = further cases of sore-feet, who had however were assisted by a motor-lorry borrowed by the Quartermaster.	Sheet 28. H 12 a 4.C
			A permanent fatigue-party was sent to near YPRES, consisting of 150 under 2nd Lts Hegarty & Earle, for R.E. work.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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Army Form C. 2118

(3)

Place	Date 1916 JUNE	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Camp 'K' (near POPERINGHE)	9th		Commencing from this day, a fatigue-party of 100 was furnished daily to bury cables, while at this camp. Usual routine during the day. Party of 350 proceeded by motor-buses to BRIELEN to bury cables at night.	
	10th		Usual routine. Lieut Tisdall relieved Lt Hegarty in charge of YPRES fatigue-party.	
	11th		Usual routine & fatigue-party of 100 as above. Father Brown said mass in camp, & then was Church of England Service with 2/Coldstream.	
	12th		A wet day and nothing unusual.	
	13th		Another wet day - Scots Guards Band arrived to be billeted with 1st Batt.	
	14th		Usual routine - Band played in camp. Intelligence lecture by Capt Griff (Divisional G.S.O.2) - Captain R.G.C. YERBURGH left for a tour of duty at Central Training School, Havre -	
	15th		Band played in camp during the morning. Lieut J.K. GREER assumed command of No 1 Platoon being on a Court. Lieut J.N. MARSHALL joined from Reinforcing Batt.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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Army Form C. 2118

(4)

Place	Date 1916 JUNE	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Canal Bank, YPRES.	15th (Cont'd)	11.30 pm	Entrained within mile of camp for Canal-bank, YPRES. Detrained at YPRES Asylum & marched to dug-outs about ½ mile NORTH of the town, preparatory to taking over line.	Sheet 28 C 25a
	16th		Lt Col Rutherford returned & resumed command. Some slight shelling on the Canal bank - 1 man wounded.	
	17th	12 noon	Relieved 2nd RDS 4th by 11th Essex Regt & 8th Bedfordshire Regt (6th Div.) in the line, 3 companies from former & one from latter. Relief surprisingly quick, complete by 1-0 a.m. No 1 on the Right from a point (C 14 d 5.6) about 500 yds E of the road to PILCKEM & just under a mile E of the Canal. No 2 in the centre. (both Companies having 2 platoons in support). No 3 on the left, reaching to a point (C 13 d 8.3), about 900 yds due E of the first bend in the Canal, N of Ypres. No 4 in Support, 3 platoons near LANCASHIRE FM, and 1 platoon on the Canal Bank (C 19 c 5-4) where were Batt: H^d Qrs	C 13, 14 & 19.
Trenches E of Canal, N of YPRES.	17th			

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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Army Form C. 2118

(5)

Place	Date 1916 JUNE	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches E & N of YPRES	17th		The trenches were on the whole poor. Only one Communication-Trench (SKIPTON RD) on extreme Left, that was really clear of water. Front line parapet thin & low, especially on the Right, where No 1 Coy suffered when Sniped the first day, it being in many places then impossible to stand upright. No 3 Coy a sap in their line, & there was also a large one on our Right when we joined next Batn. Sniping has been non-existant in our line, & the hostile machine gun fire at nights was also heavy. The Coldstream Battns drew the Left Sector by lot, and were on our Left, joining up with the French. On completion of the Divisional relief, the 3rd Guards Brigade took over (48 hours later) the Sector on our Right. The day passed quietly except for the hostile sniping, which accounted for 2 other ranks killed, & 1 died of wounds & 4 wounded.	

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Army Form C. 2118

(6)

Place	Date 1916 JUNE	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches W of PILCKEM, road N of YPRES	18th		A normal quiet day in the line = considerable work was necessary in view of probable offensive operations in the near future. 3 officers' patrols were sent out to examine the German wire, & 2nd Lt. F.H.N. Lee was unlucky enough to be wounded in the leg while close to the German wire = & was carried back most of the way to our own line by no 3836. Corporal Redmond. Lieut Hon P. Ogilvy had a luckier escape, finding his way by mistake into the German wire again on his return journey, & being heavily fired on, which his orderly had to leave his rifle entangled in the wire. Enemy's snipers less successful owing to improvement in parapets. Casualties — 1 man killed, 1 officer & 1 man wounded.	
	19th		During the night of the 18th/19th Lieut J.N. MARSHALL was wounded in the arm while with a working party, but he completed the work before reporting himself — a matter of over 2 hours. The day was normal, probably the Quietest of the tour. Casualties — 1 man killed, 1 officer & 2 other ranks wounded.	

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Army Form C. 2118

(1)

Place	Date 1916 JUNE	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
ELVERDINGHE	20th		Same trenches as on previous day. Another quiet day in the Line. Casualties – 1 killed and 2 wounded. The 2nd Bn. Grenadiers relieved the Batt.n during the night, but not until after midnight.	
	21st		Hd Qrs & Nos 1 & 2 Coys marched to ELVERDINGHE CHATEAU, arriving there just before daylight: Hd Qrs, officers & 1 platoon in the Chateau itself, remainder in Sandbag dug outs & cellars in the grounds. The house almost undamaged except by shrapnel in a few places, despite the fact that it is within almost 4000 yds of the German line. Nos 3 & 4 Coys remained in dug outs on the Canal Bank, where the Batt.n had been on the night of the 15th/16th inst. The usual inspections on coming out of trenches were held. A certain amount of drill was possible under the trees in the Chateau grounds, but careful watch had to be kept for hostile aeroplanes. The 2nd Batt.n were in Camp O, about a mile to the westward.	
	22nd		Nos 3 & 4 Coys from the Canal bank were employed on a night digging-fatigue, to work on a new Communication trench on the Right of our line.	

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(8)

Place	1916 Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches W of PILCKEM N of YPRES	23rd JUNE		One NCO wounded during the early morning, returning from the digging fatigue. Ordinary routine - Some bathing was possible for swimmers in the Chateau Lake - Lieut F.L. PUSCH DSO, & 2nd Lieuts N. BUTLER & T.F. MACMASTER joined from Reserve Battn	
	24th		Our Artillery ~~bombarded~~ cut wire on many points on the Division front during the morning, with a view to ~~the~~ contemplated raids - There was also some night Artillery fire, & one relief on the 2nd Bn. Grenadiers was ordered to be as early as darkness would allow.	
		10-0 pm	Companies from Canal bank moved up first, & those from Elverdinghe marched about 9.35 pm = the whole relief being complete by at midnight - A quiet night. 1 Corporal wounded.	
	25th		Dispositions as before, except that No 1 came back into Support, being relieved by No 4 on the Right front. A quiet day and night: trenches much improved & consequently dry. Two men wounded, of whom one died.	
	26th		Except for slight shelling on the Right in retaliation - a quiet day. Heavy rain hampered the work very considerably, much of our new work being waterlogged, especially new Communication trenches. Casualties — 4 other ranks wounded.	

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Army Form C. 2118

(9)

Place	Date 1916 JUNE	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches W of PILCKEM rd, N of YPRES	27th	8.0 pm	A repetition of the wire-cutting of 26th was done by the Artillery throughout a wet morning, leading to considerable retaliation on our trenches, ~~[illegible]~~ causing some casualties. Lieut F.L. PUSCH DSO was shot by a sniper ~~[illegible]~~ & killed instantaneously. He and his orderly went to pick up a man who had been wounded at a bad place in the trench, & were both hit themselves by one bullet. No 4009 Pte J. CARROLL was mainly concerned in getting the 2 wounded men & the officer's body under cover from a nasty position, under the fire of the enemy's snipers. Total casualties for the day :- 1 offr & 2 men killed, 7 ~~[illegible]~~ O.R. wounded, of which 1 died of wounds next day. The enemy carried on his retaliation through the night and the day, with more effect. No 4 Company on the Right were the chief sufferers, the trenches of their 2 front platoons (under Lt LEVY) being very badly knocked about, besides which communication trenches and other lines were heavily shelled with 4·2, 5·9, minenwerfer & Aerial torpedoes.	
	28th			

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Army Form C. 2118

(10)

Place	Date 1916 JUNE	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
from Trenches.	28th (Contd)		Our heavy artillery failed do stop the shelling which went on at intervals until the afternoon - Casualties were the heaviest since October — 5 other ranks (including Sergt O'Brien 4637), and 6 wounded (including Sergt Lowe, a platoon Sergt) - 9 of these casualties being in the 2 Advanced platoons of no 4 Coy. The Batn was relieved by the 1st Batn Coldstream Gds (2nd Gds Bde) at night, the relief being complete a few minutes after midnight. marched to 'O' Camp, in the "A 30 wood", about 2 miles NE of POPERINGHE.	
Camp O, near POPERINGHE.	29th		The Camp consisted of good huts, but owing to the recent heavy rains the ground was very wet = for the same reason a special issue of rum was given by Brigade order, all Companies being in Camp just before daybreak. 2 men wounded during relief - The usual inspections were held during the day.	
	30th		Total casualties during the 12 days (8 in trenches) — 3 officers + 47 other ranks. Usual routine — steady drill &c, in Camp.	

R. McCalmont
Major 1st/3rd Irish Guards.

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

1st BATTALION

IRISH GUARDS.

JULY 1916

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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1st Batt. Irish Guards.

Army Form C. 2118.

Place	Date 1916 JULY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
CAMP O, in A 30 Wood, nr POPERINGHE.	1st to 6th		Batn in Divisional Reserve in O camps, about 2 miles NE of POPERINGHE, in "A 30 Wood". The usual training was carried on, also an Inter-platoon Bomb-Throwing Competition to accustom men to throw "over-arm" without jerking & firing the arms. The Scots Gds Band played in camp once, & there were open air concerts, both Battns of Coldstream being in adjoining camps. 2nd Lt J. W. EARLE was officially transferred to the 1st Gds Bde & T. M. Battery (Stokes Guns) dating from 20.6.16. 2nd Lt N. BUTLER to Hospital (Sick) 30.6.16.	
CANAL BANK (YPRES)	7th		Batn moved to the CANAL BANK after dark, in Brigade Reserve for the RIGHT Sub-sector of RIGHT Sector: Batn H.Q. Qrs + Nos 3 + 4 coys being in dug outs on the banks of the YPER LYS & remainder on E bank of the CANAL itself: 2 platoons of No 1 being in Support of 2nd Batn Grenadier Gds one at their Batn H.Q. - IRISH FM & one at "FRASCATI". Lieut M.B. LEVY went to Hospital, Sick, before the move. The dug outs occupied were about ½ mile N of YPRES, the two lots being connected by a tunnel through the Bank separating the 2 bits of water.	Sheet 28. N.W. & Sheet 25. E. & S.W.

T2134. Wt. W708—776. 500000. 4/15. Sir J. C. & S.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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WAR DIARY
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1st Bn. Irish Guards.

Army Form C. 2118. 2

Place	Date 1916 JULY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Canal Bank N of YPRES.	8th		Except for nightly fatigue-parties of about 200 each, no training was possible while on the CANAL BANK, but there was little shelling. One man wounded on this day. Lieut Count J. E. de SALIS joined the Battn for duty, from Sick-leave granted while doing duty with Machine Gun Coy.	
Trenches N of WIELTJE.	9th 10th 11th		As on 8th. No casualties. 2 platoons no 2 relieved no 1 in support. no 4009 Pte CARROLL received the Military Medal, having brought in Lt Pusch's body under fire. Battn relieved 2nd Bn. Grenadier Guards in the line starting at 11-0 pm. The line taken over being on the immediate LEFT of that held by the Battn in May 1916, when Battn H.Q. were at ST JEAN: but a newly dug front line was held about 200 yds further forward. No 4 Coy on the RIGHT from C 22 C 3·2 (N of WIELTJE FM) to BUFFS RD (S of CROSS RDS FM, exclusive): no 3 thence to FORWARD COTTAGE: and no 1 on the LEFT to about C 21 a 9·7 where except for a small gap in a marsh, we joined the Coldstream Battn. The 6th Div being on our R. No 2 in Support, half at Battn H.Q. (just W of IRISH FM. in the X line of trenches) & other platoons in various posts.	Sheet 23

T2134. Wt. W708—776. 500000. 4/15. Sir J. C. & S.

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1st Bn. Irish Guards.

Army Form C. 2118. 13

Place	1916 Date JULY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches N of WIELTJE	12th (Contd)		There was some shelling during the relief, during which Lieut S.E.F. CHRISTY was killed: the night was otherwise quiet. During the morning, in addition to some shelling, a party of 4 Germans got through the very broken line held by No 1 Coy, evidently crawling up through dry ditches + long grass = they were not seen until they appeared behind an isolated post of 2 NCOs + 5 men who were in a very shallow bit of trench + unable to stand up without being in view. Four of them were taken by surprise + held up with revolvers, but on being marched off as prisoners they managed to edge towards the platoon on their right who saw them + opened fire: all 4 men got back into our trench, one German was wounded but they all escaped through the long grass. Desultory shelling all day increased at about 6.0 pm to almost a bombardment of every trench with guns up to 5.9". = considering the bad cover the casualties were very light, + the shelling stopped about 8.30 pm. Casualties for the day — 1 offr + 3 OR killed. 19 OR - wounded	

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1/4 B^n. Irish Guards. 4

WAR DIARY
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Army Form C. 2118.

Instructions regarding War Diaries and Intelligence Summaries are contained in F. S. Regs., Part II. and the Staff Manual respectively. Title pages will be prepared in manuscript.

Place	1916 Date July	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches W of WIELTJE	13th		A quiet day except for some desultory shelling, possibly due to the enemy's desire to hide withdrawal of guns to the SOUTH. A great deal of work was necessary, especially drainage, and mostly only possible at night. Casualties. 7 OR wounded. 2nd Lieut G.V. WILLIAMS arrived to join the Batn. from the Base. Major C.F. FLEMING left the Batn. Sick, in the early morning.	
	14th		A quiet day, but enemy was showing considerable activity in front of his lines at night, and a strong patrol was organised under Lieut J.N. MARSHALL to reconnoitre the broad expanse of ground in front of our RIGHT = the officer was wounded in the leg just before leaving our trenches but insisted on going on, & remained out about 2 hours. No enemy were met but much activity heard. Casualties 1 officer (remained at duty) & 1 OR. wounded.	
	15th		After a quiet day, Batn. was relieved immediately after dark by 2nd Bn. Grenadier Guards, & returned to former quarters on the CANAL Bank no 2 leaving 2 platoons in support. Casualties 5 OR wounded (of whom one died).	

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1st Bn. Irish Guards.

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Place	Date 1916 JULY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	14th		The Commanding Officer, as the senior of the 2 Battns, was ordered to detail an officer and 20 other ranks, to form part of the British Contingent to represent the British Army at the French Review in PARIS on the 14th July.	
			The following were selected, and proceeded under the command of Captain J.S.N. FITZGERALD (late 2nd Battn.); they were selected chiefly from those who had served with the Battn. since the commencement of the campaign.—	
			No. 3972 CQMSgt R. Grady No 3 Coy. No 2618 Sergt M. Riordan No 1 Coy.	
			No. 3783 Sgt M. Whelan " 3 " No. 4627 Sergt. F. Taite " 4 "	
			No 3662 L/Cpl P. Geoghan " 1 " " 2044 Pte W. Byrne " 1 "	
			" 2996 Pte P. O'Regan " 1 " " 3934 Pte J. Patterson 1 "	
			" 3920 Pte A Blanchfield " 1 " " 4085 Pte J. Hearne " 2 "	
			" 4009 Pte J. Carroll " 3 " " 2104 Pte J. Feeley " 3 "	
			" 2714 Pte M Dunne " 4 " " 5336 Pte D. Hegarty " 1 " (ex R.I.C.)	
			The Contingent were given an enthusiastic reception in Paris.	

Special Contingent to

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5

Place	Date 1916 JULY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches N of WIELTJE.	16th		A very quiet day on the Canal. Night digging parties as before.	
	17th		As on 16th. Lieut R. RANKIN rejoined from Central Training School, HAVRE, & took command of No 2 Coy. Lt K.W. HOGG to Hospital sick. 1 man wounded. No 3 took over 2 support platoons.	
	18th		After a quiet day, relieved 2nd B^n. Grenadiers in the same line, No 2 Coy taking CENTRE, & No 3 going into Support. A quiet relief - no casualties.	
	19th		Trenches much improved, largely owing to dry warm weather. Enemy keeping very quiet, probably having had a recent relief. Efforts made nightly by patrols to take a prisoner for identification purposes, were not successful. No casualties	
	20th		Another quiet day. 1 man wounded.	
	21st		Quiet. Lieut HOLMES & his platoon of No 1 made strenuous efforts to catch a prisoner, & he reconnoitred an Enemy sap going through their first line right up to their trench. 2346 L/Cpl Hennigan 5743 Pte O'Brien were very prominent in this work during this tour. Capt R.V. POLLOK joined Batt^n, but did not take command of a Coy until after relief.	

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1st Bn. Irish Guards. 6

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Place	1916 Date JULY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches N of YPRES Canal Bank & WIELTJE.	22nd		After a quiet day, Batn was relieved by 2nd Bn. Grenadier Gds & returned to former quarters on Canal bank leaving 2 platoons of no 3 Coy in support. A quiet relief on the whole - 3 OR - wounded (1 subsequently died).	
	23rd		Orders for the Brigade to go out into rest commencing tonight were cancelled, owing to the impending move of the Division. Capt R V. POLLOK took command of no 1. 2nd Lt F.S.L. SMITH joined. A quiet day except for the support platoons who were shelled by a H.V. Gun about 6", & were lucky to have only one man killed.	
	24th		Remained on Canal bank. Quiet day. 1 man wounded. No 4 Coy took over 2. Support platoons.	
	25th		Relieved 2nd Bn. Grenadiers after a quiet day, at dusk. Capt R V POLLOK was unlucky enough to be hit by a machine gun bullet just before reaching his trenches. no other casualties. No 4 Coy in support, being relieved by no 3 on the Right.	
	26th		A quiet day in the line. warm weather. no casualties.	

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Place	Date 1916 JULY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches N of WIELTJE	27th		After a normal day in the trenches, Batt^n was relieved after dusk by the 1st Batt. Royal Warwickshire Regt (10th B^de, 4th Div) recently come from the South after having been in the fighting there. The relief was carried out smoothly & quietly. Casualties during the 24 hours — 1 (2 Lt Rose) killed. 3 OR. wounded. Platoons marched independently to the siding at the YPRES Asylum:	
	28th		thence at 1.30 am by rail to POPERINGHE. Billets were S of the Square, the town having been heavily shelled about a week previously, and completely evacuated for some days. A restful day was spent in Inspections and baths, after 21 consecutive days spent in dug-outs.	
POPERINGHE	29th		Another quiet day with inspections and a short Company parades. General Sir H Plumer commanding the 2nd Army visited Brigade HQ. to express his thanks to the Brigade for their work in the YPRES salient, in view of their approaching move South. In this connection, the following Summary of —	

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1st B.n Irish Guards.

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Place	Date 1916 JULY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
			Casualties from March 18th to July 28th while in the YPRES Salient (excluding 4 weeks in rest), is of interest:—	
			Killed (or died of wounds) — 4 officers. 33 other ranks.	
			Wounded — 5 officers. 143 other ranks	
			Total. — 9 offrs & 176 other ranks.	
			all being in the course of ordinary trench warfare.	
	30th		Transport marched at 4.30 am and Batn. at 6.30 am for PROVEN, where they entrained in very hot weather.	
			Left at 9-10 am for ST. POL, where train arrived at 2.30 pm: the whole Division being moved in 42 trains in one day.	
BOUQUEMAISON			Thence in 47 motor lorries (Transport by route march) to BOUQUEMAISON, a distance of about 16 miles towards DOULLENS.	
			Weather very hot, and roads very dusty.	
			Billets good for the men, but practically none for officers: the Hd Qrs mess being in the open in an orchard.	
	31st		A quiet hot day in billets.	

R. McCalmont Lt Col
Comdg 1st B.n Irish Gds

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1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

1st BATTALION

IRISH GUARDS.

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1st Batt Irish Guards

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1

Vol 25

Place	Date 1916 AUG	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
BOUQUEMAISON	1st	6-30 a.m.	Marched as a Brigade from BOUQUEMAISON for VAUCHELLES, about 12 miles march through DOULLENS in very hot weather. Battalion in very rough huts roofed with Tarpaulins = officers in tents and bivouacs in an orchard. The march was a trying one and a few men collapsed = great coats + Steel helmets were carried in lorries.	
VAUCHELLES	2nd		Usual routine in billets.	
	3rd		The Band of the Regiment arrived from England for their 3 months tour, under the command of Lieut J. P. Gough - who returned to England = the Band was attached to the Batt. for accomodation, rations &c as a temporary measure, to suit Divisional H.Qrs.	
	4th		Usual routine = the Band gave an afternoon concert.	2nd Lt D. H. COOKE joined from 4th Bn Comt. Reserve.
	5th		Ordinary training = the Band played for the officers in the evening	
	6th		Mass was said in the open and Church of England service with 3rd Bn Coldstream who were billited in the adjoining camps = the Band played at both services. Lieut. T. BUTLER-STONER and 2nd Lt N. BUTLER joined from Extending Batt. = the latter from Hospital	

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(2)

Place	Date 1916 AUG	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
L'AUTIE	7th		Usual routine in billets.	
	8th		Usual routine, including Company route-marches.	
I			Lieut J. N. MARSHALL went to Hospital, as the result of his wound received 24th July. The Band left to join Div. H.Qrs.	
CI				
III	9th		H.M. The King visited all Battalions of the Division, in the course	
I			of the day = no special arrangements were ordered and No 3 Coy	
I			carried on with Bombing assault practice.	
III			His Majesty passed through the orchard in which the officers messes	
I			were pitched, and all officers present were presented to him.	
C			He then passed through the men's lines in his motor, and back	
O			again after visiting the 3rd Batt. Coldstream: the Batt. turned	
F			out & cheered on both occasions.	
Y	10th		Usual training routine. Lieut W. C. MUMFORD joined Batt.	
			from hour =	
	11th	10-15 am	marched via LOUVENCOURT & BERTRANCOURT to camp in the woods	
			just S of MAILLY-MAILLET, about 6 miles in hot dusty weather.	

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1st Batt. Irish Guards

Army Form C. 2118.

(3)

Place	Date 1916 AUG	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MAILLY-MAILLET.	11th (cont'd)		The Battalion was preceded by the 2nd Bn. Grenadiers & 3rd Bn. Coldstream, the Brigade taking over trenches E of ENGLEBELMER, with 2nd Bn. Coldstream in Reserve & 1st Bn. Irish Gds in Support.	
	12th		Trenches were dry in the camps, which consisted of rough huts only, and was well within the shell-area. There was a bombardment of the enemy trenches at about 10.30 pm but no apparent retaliation.	
Wood near MAILLY.	13th		The Commanding Offrs & Company Commanders reconnoitred the rear lines with a view to taking over on 15th, but unexpected orders were received at night for the Brigade to move out of the line next day.	
	14th	9.20 am	Marched by Companies to LOUVENCOURT, about 4½ miles: warm & rainy weather: Batt. billeted in the village, taking over from 2nd Batt. Sherwood Foresters. Lieut Hon P. Ogilvy took over duties of Transport Offr, temporarily.	
LOUVENCOURT.	15th		A wet day: the Batt. found themselves in the same village as the	

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1st Bat. Irish Guards

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(4)

Place	1916 Date AUG	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	15th (cont.)		of the Expeditionary Force Canteens which are not often found near the front line billets, and Pay having been arranged considerable use was made of it. 2nd Lt J. N. WARD joined from home.	
	16th		Marched via BERTRANCOURT to COURCELLES where dinners were issued = thence via COLINCAMPS to line of trenches opposite SERRE, which was taken over from 1st Somerset L.I. (61st Bde) by about 5.30pm. The front was a narrow one, from K 35 a 6.9 near SERRE on the Right to K 29 c 8.9, the 3rd Guards Bde being on our Right, & the 2nd Bn Coldstream on our Left. Bn HQrs about K 28 d 1.1. No 3 Coy held the Right, & No 4 the Left, with No 1 in Support and No 2 in Reserve at BASIN WOOD. The trenches were deep and numerous with good Communication trenches — a vast improvement on the YPRES Salient: only the front line being bad. 2nd Lieut T.C. GIBSON joined the 1st Line Transport (N of COURCELLES) from home. The relief was quiet and carried out in daylight. No casualties.	Trench Map 57 D NE
trenches opposite SERRE	17th		Nothing special to record = most of the work in addition to improving	

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1st Bde Irish Guards

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(5)

Place	Date 1916 AUG	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	17th (cont)		the damaged front line, consisted in salvage: there were also a large number of British dead of Yorkshire & Lancashire Bdes, as the result of the early July operations. Casualties — 2 men wounded.	
	18th		Weather turned very wet; ~~the~~ the enemy was inactive except for minenwerfer chiefly on the Coldstream on our Left. 2nd Guards Bde had now also moved from the Right of the Division front, to our Left. 2 men wounded (1 at duty).	
Relieved by 2nd Guards Bde	19th		Still very wet: no particular incidents to report, but our aeroplanes showed much activity & gallantry throughout the tour — another great contrast to the Ypres Salient. 5 men wounded, including 4 by a fall of earth while working on dug outs.	
	20th		Batt. relieved during the afternoon by 13th Essex Regt (6th Bde), the whole Brigade being relieved in the line. Relief was complete by 4.30 pm, and there was ~~some~~ shelling and "minenwerfering" during the afternoon: only one casualty.	

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Place	Date AUG	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
WARNIMONT	20th (cont)		Batt: marched by platoons to COURCELLES where tea was issued, thence by Companies via BUS-LES-ARTOIS to Retirements at N end of the BOIS DE WARNIMONT (SE of AUTHIE), arriving about 8-0 pm.	
BOIS DU			Capt L.R. HARGREAVES joined from hour & took over command of No 1 from the following day.	
	21st		Usual routine of inspections &c.	
			Lieut H.F d'A LAW left the Batt: for temporary employment on Intelligence work.	
	22nd		Usual routine, training &c.	
	23rd		Batt: marched at the head of the Brigade to BEAUVAL, about 11 miles, via AUTHIE - THIEVRES - SARTON - TERRAMESNIL.	
BEAUVAL.			Billets considerably above the average.	
			Lieut P.H. ANTROBUS joined Batt: from hour, and resumed duty as Transport Offrs.	
	24th		Marched about 9-0 am with remainder of Brigade, via TALMAS,	

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1st Batt. Irish Guards

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7.

Place	Date 1916 AUG	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
FLESSELLES	24th (Cont.)		To FLESSELLES, about 10 miles South – Billets poor. 2nd Lt G.V. WILLIAMS took over the duties of Intelligence & Signalling – The Brigadier conveyed his approval of the salvage-work done by the Batt. between 16th–20th inst, which included in addition to 200 bodies buried – 133 Rifles, 93 Bayonets 68 Steel helmets & 132 Lewis gun magazines.	
	25th		Battalion moved with remainder of Brigade by a circuitous route to MEAULTÉ near the extreme Right of the British line –	
MEAULTE.		9.30 am	marched to CANAPLES (about 5 miles) : thence by "tactical train" to MERICOURT-L'ABBÉ : this journey occupied from 12-45 pm to about 6-30 pm, progress after passing AMIENS being very slow & spasmodic owing to the heavy traffic – The 2nd Bn. Grenadiers, 1st Bde Bde M.G. Coy & other units all travelled in the same train (over 2000 in all) which was very crowded – Marched from MERICOURT to MÉAULTÉ (about 6 miles) in wet weather, to find poor billets : the whole Brigade being in the village – The Division was now again in XIV th Corps, which had joined 4th Army about 10 days before, leaving the 1st Div temporarily in V th Corps.	

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Place	Date 1916 AUG	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	25th (cont'd)		2nd Lieut D.H. COOKE left the Batt. en route, to join 3rd Reserve Batt. at home for further training.	
	26th		Usual routine in billets which were poor, being low-lying, & dirty, & infested with flies.	
	27th		Torrential rain all day. Mass in Church.	
	28th		Training re-started in trench work & open-country fighting.	
	29th		Usual training continued in the same bad weather.	
	30th		In addition to training, Company Commanders went to 9th Sq. R.F.C. Hd Qrs for demonstration in communications between aeroplanes & Infantry. Weather continued bad.	
			There was heavy gunfire during the night on the battle front.	
	31st		Training Continued, including Bombing, Lewis Guns etc. Some improvement in weather conditions but the roads still in a wintry state, & continuous heavy traffic of all kinds through the Village.	

R. McCalmont Lt Col
Comdg 1st Bn Irish Gds

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1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

1st BATTALION

IRISH GUARDS.

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Vol 26

Place	Date 1916	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MÉAULTE	September			
	1		The Battalion continued its training	
	2		The Battalion continued its training	
	3		The Battalion attended Mass in MÉAULTE Church. At 11 A.M. there was Brigade Church parade (C. of E.) at which the Irish Guards Band was expected to play but was prevented from coming. In the afternoon the Battalion sent detachments of infantry & bombers in attack order for inspection by the Major General commanding the Guards Division who inspected detachments in attack order from each battalion of the three Guards Brigades.	
	4		In very wet weather the Battalion continued its training. At about 11 P.M. the Battalion was warned, in view of successes gained by the French, to be ready to leave billets at 3 hours' notice.	
	5		Three hours' notice was cancelled in the morning and the Battalion practised assaulting from trenches in presence	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	September 5 (continued)			
			of the Brigadier in dull cold weather. At 7/50 pm news was received that the Guards' Division must be prepared to leave at short notice after 5 a.m. the next morning in view of further successes gained by the French.	
	6		The warning changed to 2 hours & cancelled about midday. Battalion continued training.	
	7		Battalion continued training. At 7 pm Battalion had night operations practising marking out a line of trenches	
	8		There was a Brigade field day on Brigade training ground, the 2nd & 3rd Battalions COLDSTREAM assaulting two lines of trenches with 2nd Battalion GRENADIER GUARDS in support & the Battalion commanded by Major BAILEY, in the absence on short leave of the Commanding Officer, in reserve. Visual signalling to contact aeroplanes was practised successfully. From 6 to 7.30 pm the Band played outside Battalion Headquarters at MEAULTE.	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MÉAULTE	September		Lt-~~Gen~~. General	
	9		Battalion did practice attack. In afternoon, Sir Alexander GODLEY,	
	"		(formerly IRISH GUARDS) commanding 2nd ANZAC Corps visited	
	"		Bn Headquarters	
"	10		~~Battalion~~ Brigade left MÉAULTE at 9.40 a.m. & marched to CARNOY by	Ref. map Albert (combined sheets) 1/40000
CARNOY	"		cross-tracks & bivouacked in a field on the slopes of the valley	
	"		outside the village (about F18 b 80). On arriving the Battalion was	
	"		placed on 10 minutes' notice. At 9 p.m. No: 3 & 4 Coys were	
BERNAFAY WOOD	"		ordered to meet guides at 3rd Brigade HQ in BERNAFAY WOOD	Ref. map France 57c S.W. 1/20,000
	"		(about S28 b 42) to relieve 2nd SCOTS GUARDS (2 coys) & to be	
			in support to the 3rd Brigade. No. 3 & 4 Coys occupied trenches	
			running West to East in BERNAFAY WOOD for an hour & were	
			then ordered up to a line of trenches behind GINCHY (across T19 b).	
			Both companies were in the line No: 3 on right of road, No: 4 on	
			left, No: 3 being practically in front line as the	
			GRENADIERS had only a few men in shell holes in front. These two	
			companies relieved the 1st BAttalion WELSH GUARDS. & were under	
			Major TMD Bailie.	
			A bombing accident in the trenches resulted in 6 men being wounded.	

T2134. Wt. W708—776. 500000. 4/15. Sir J. C. & S.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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WAR DIARY
or
~~INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.~~
(Erase heading not required.)

1st Batt Irish Guards

Army Form C. 2118.

4

Place	Date 1916 Sept	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
BERNAFAY WOOD	11th	6.20 am	Although the short notice for a move was cancelled during the night, at orders were received for HQrs & the remaining 2 Coys to move to BERNAFAY WOOD in support of the 3rd Guards Bde, & they arrived there by	
		9.0 am	& bivouacked in the old trenches in the N end of the wood. Nos 3 + 4 Coys continued to hold a Support Line on the N.W. end of GINCHY where they were heavily shelled. Nos 1 + 2 remained in Brigade Reserve all day & night, being chiefly employed in carrying fatigues for the Batts of the 3rd Gds Bde in the Line: Total casualties for the day — 7 OR killed & 13 wounded.	
"	12th		In the early hours of the morning, the whole Batt was relieved by various Batts of 3rd Gds Bde, & returned to bivouac at CARNOY. Shortly after dark, the Batt moved again to BERNAFAY WOOD, preparatory to the attack arranged for the near future: 2 Coys (3+4) being in the trenches in the centre of ~~the~~ the wood, & Nos 1 & 2 further East, in a small copse E of TRONES WOOD. The latter were unlucky to have 3 men killed & 5 wounded (Lewis Gunners) by one shell.	

T2134. Wt. W708—776. 500000. 4/15. Sir J. C. & S.

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WAR DIARY
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1st Battalion Irish Guards.

Army Form C. 2118.

(5)

Place	Date 1916	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
BERNAFAY WOOD	13th Sept		Except for Carrying fatigues and the noise of our bombardment, the Batt. spent a quiet day. 1 OR killed & 4 wounded on fatigues.	
	14th		a busy but quiet day spent in the same positions, preparing for next day's attack, in which the equipment to be carried consisted of:- Haversack in lieu of pack, 2 mills bombs, 2 days rations, 2 extra bandoliers S.A.A., a pick or shovel & 3 sandbags per man. Companies were also kept busy on various fatigues through the day. The new Armoured "tanks" attracted considerable attention when moving up to their positions during the evening. The Batt. moved off after dark to its assembly-position, and lay in the open in shell holes or trenches in the formation in which it was to advance. The 2 Coldstream Batts (2nd on Right & 3rd on Left) occupied the front trenches & led the attack: 2nd Bn. Grenadiers in rear of them responsible for the flanks & the consolidation of the first objective, & 1st Bn. Irish Guards to support the Coldstream & finally to take the fourth or final objective.	

T2134. Wt. W708—776. 500000. 4/15. Sir J. C. & S.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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WAR DIARY
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1st Batt: Irish Guards. Army Form C. 2118. (6)

Place	Date 1916 Sept	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
near GINCHY	15th		The Battalion formed up, its right on S.24 b 9.5 (N.W. of GINCHY) facing NORTH EAST, in two lines Nos. 3 & 4 Coys were in the front line, Nos. 1 & 2 Coys. in the 2nd line Nos. 1 & 2 Coys. being on the RIGHT – Companies commanded as follows:-	
			No. 1 Coy Lieut. J. K. GREER, M.C.	
			" 2 " Captain R. RANKIN	
			" 3 " Captain C. PEASE	
			" 4 " Captain P.S. LONG-INNES	
			the following being left in Reserve – Capt. S. R. Hargreaves, Lieuts. Hon. O. L. Ogilvy and R. Rodakowski and 2nd Lieut. J. C. Gibson also C.S.M. MORRIS MOYLES and FARRELL	
			Lieut. L. C. WHITEFORD and his Section of the Brigade Mac. Gun Coy was attached to the Battalion	
		6.20AM.	At 6.20 am. the Battalion moved off as ordered. The two leading Platoons of No 3 Coy. and probably some of No 4 Coy. rushed the German first line (called YAT ALLEY on some maps) running almost due East and West from the point where the SUNKEN ROAD leaves the North end of GINCHY. These Platoons seem to have closed in on the two Battalions of the Coldstream Guards attacking.	

T2134. Wt. W708—776. 500000. 4/15. Sir J. C. & S.

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WAR DIARY
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INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.
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1st Battn IRISH GUARDS.

Army Form C. 2118.

(7)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near GINCHY	1916 SEPT. 15TH		Our men got their blood up and it was here that our first wave went forward in an irresistable rush with the Coldstreamers. They contrived to keep their direction but on the way the 2nd Guards Brigade closed in on the right of the 1st, heading too much towards the North. The Right half of the Brigade Area was the more heavily shelled, the German barrage extending particularly to the hollow about 300 yards South of the GREEN LINE. This helped to shear portions of the 2nd Guards Brigade still further northwards.	
	7.50AM		Battalion Headquarters reached the wire in front of the 1st German line (about T 8. d. 5.) towards 7:50 a.m. By this time the whole Battalion was either in front of the wire or in the GREEN LINE, the Right front Company being about T 8. d. 2. 8. to 19. and part of the Right Second Line Company being about the same spot. The remainder were at the Western end of the objective. By this time three of the original Company Commanders had become casualties (Nos. 2, 3 & 4) and all the Officers of the Left rear Company (No. 2 Company) were out of action. Major T. M. D. BAILIE who was with the two leading Companies, as 2nd in Command, also being	

T2134. Wt. W708—776. 500000. 4/15. Sir J. C. & S.

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WAR DIARY
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INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.
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1st Battalion Irish Guards.

Army Form C. 2118.

(8.)

Place	Date 1916 SEPT.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near GINCHY.	15th		Before entering the GREEN LINE, Battalion Headquarters despatched a Pigeon message to the Brigade, and as there appeared to be no movement in the position, Battalion Headquarters entered the GREEN LINE, which was found to be densely crowded, every unit of the 1st and 2nd Guards Brigades being represented. The Commanding Officer of the 2nd Batt. Irish Guards with two of his Officers was found here as well as fresh troops of the 14th Division waiting to attack their 2nd objective.	

It appears that the Officers Commanding the two Battalions of the Coldstream Guards were under the impression that they had gained at least two objectives and this was responsible for the delay that ensued. The further reorganisation of the position was considerably hampered by a party of Germans who were clearly visible in the Communication Trench about T.8.b.2.8. with a machine gun and Snipers under the direction of an Officer. The remaining Coy. Commander (Lieut. J.K. GREER) fell a victim to one of these Snipers. Three Lewis Guns were turned on to the enemy position by the Commanding Officer's Order but each jammed in succession.

T2134. Wt. W708—776. 500000. 4/15. Sir J. C. & S.

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1st Battn Irish Guards (91)

Army Form C. 2118.

Place	1916. Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near GINCHY	15TH SEPT.		Presently a large number of Germans, who had surrendered, were seen returning on our left front, probably owing to the advance of the 14th Division. After a consultation between the Commanding Officer and the Officers Comdg the 2nd and 3rd Battalions of Coldstream Guards in order to verify the position on the map, every effort was now made to get the men of the 2nd Guards Brigade to move along the GREEN LINE trench towards their own area, and the Coldstream Guards, the two battalions mixed together, with a few men of the 1st Battalion Irish Guards, under Lieut. MUMFORD, gradually pushed forward. In the meantime, despite rather heavy shelling, a certain amount of consolidation was done on the trench	
	11:15AM		while the work of reorganisation was continued. About 11:15 AM. word was received that both Commanders of the battalions of Coldstream Guards had advanced on the next objective. At 11:25 AM. the remainder of the battalion, consisting of the Commanding Officer, the Adjutant, and 2nd Lieut. G.V. WILLIAMS, together with Lieut. L.C WHITEFORD, of the Machine Gun Company, 1st Guards Brigade, followed the Coldstream Guards, with	

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1st Battn Irish Guards

Army Form C. 2118.

(10)

Place	Date 1916 SEPT	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near GINCHY	15th		every available man that could be collected, Coldstreamers included. On reaching the top of the ridge the whole panorama of the landscape between FLERS and LES BOEUFS was disclosed, in full view on the further slopes a German Battery of field guns shelled our advance. There was a good deal of shelling during our advance down the slope to the BROWN LINE which consisted of shallow trenches with a bad field of fire and no traverses.	
	11.45 AM.		By 11.45 a.m. we had assembled in this line about 60 of the 1st Battalion Irish Guards, on the left, about 30 of the 2nd Battalion Grenadier Guards under Capt. A.F.S. Cunningham and some hundred Coldstream Guards, on the right, under the command of Colonel J.V. CAMPBELL as senior officer present. There was again considerable uncertainty prevailing as to our correct position on the map but it was discovered by compass bearing that our correct position ran from T.2.D.2.3. to T.2.C.6.8. a distance of about 800 yards. We discovered to our left front, about 300 yards away, a small party (15) of the Battalion under a/Captain CARTON (subsequently Killed) and Sergeant RIORDAN, in touch with the 9th Battalion Rifle Brigade.	

T2134. Wt. W708—776. 500000. 4/15. Sir J. C. & S.

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Army Form C. 2118.

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1st Battn Irish Guards

Place	Date 1916 SEPT.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near GINCHY	15th		The right of the Coldstream Guards was in the air and the 150 contour line was just in front of us. Under more or less heavy shelling which caused a good many casualties everybody began digging themselves in. In accordance with an order sent to him by the Commanding Officer, through a wounded man Captain L. R. HARGREAVES, who had been left behind in TRONES WOOD by previous arrangement, when the battalion went into action, was rejoined. A line was now pushed out about 300 yards in front of the BROWN LINE, over the crest of the ridge by Capt. L. R. HARGREAVES together with Lieut. L.C. WHITEFORD and 2ND Lieut. J. N. WARD and G. V. WILLIAMS. This line consisting of a number of disconnected shell holes was held for the remainder of the afternoon under grave difficulty, being shelled by a field battery clearly visible on the further ridge, about 600 yards away, and continually swept by machine gun fire from the right and by snipers. With the aid of their entrenching tools the men dug themselves into their shell holes, as best they could, and some of them picked off such enemy targets as presented themselves from time to time. The line formed by this party (about 50	

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1st Battn. Irish Guards.

Army Form C. 2118.

(12.)

Place	Date 1916 SEPT.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near GINCHY	15TH		strong including a Brigade Machine Gun Detachment) was not carried on to the right but it constituted a very effective covering party for the BROWN LINE which was reinforced by the arrival of Lieut W.C MUMFORD and 2ND Lieut T.S.L. SMITH with some parties of Irish and Coldstream Guards. The Germans were reported as massing about the BLUE LINE for a counter attack and parties of troops were in effect descried advancing in artillery formation along the further slope, whilst considerable transport activity along the roads. At nightfall our forward line was regarded as untenable and by Col Campbell's order was withdrawn so that all energies might be concentrated on the consolidation of the BROWN LINE. During the afternoon the 2ND Battn. Scots Guards attacked on the right of the Coldstream Guards but were beaten back with the exception of a few men who remained in the BROWN LINE. By nightfall nearly 100 of the 1st Battn. Irish Gds had joined the party holding the BROWN LINE besides more Grenadiers and Coldstreamers. Slegion messages were sent by Colonel Campbell to the Brigade explaining our position and we also indicated it to the contact	

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1st Battalion (13) Irish Guards

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Army Form C. 2118.

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Place	Date 1916 SEPT	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near GINCHY	15th		aeroplane by flares. Lieut. L. C. WHITEFORD, 2ND LIEUT J. N. WARD, the whole machine gun team and a considerable number of the party holding the forward line had become casualties in the course of the afternoon. The night was fairly quiet. In the absence of any materials and of Verey lights a screen of men was put out on the high ground about 100 yards in front of the position and kept there throughout the night in touch, on the left with the D. of Cornwall's L. Infy. who had relieved the Rifle Brigade and on the right with the 2nd Batt. Grenadier Guards. During the night, water was sent up by the Brigade and rations were obtained from a dump on the GINCHY ~ LES BOEUFS Road where the 2nd Batt. Grenadier Guards were holding the GREEN LINE.	
~..~	16TH	9:10 AM	At 9:10 a.m. the Battalion on our left (? Somerset L. Infy.) attacked the German system of trenches South of GUEDECOURT but failed, and the Germans maintained a barrage over the Brown and Green lines. Communication with the GREEN LINE was practically impossible owing to the sloping ground being in full view of the enemy. The number of stragglers had increased	

T2134. Wt. W708—776. 500000. 4/15. Sir J. C. & S.

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1st Battalion Irish Guards.

(14)

Army Form C. 2118.

Place	Date 1916 SEPT.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
1 Car. LES BOEUFS	16th		so much that the BROWN LINE was now dangerously crowded. The line was intermittently shelled throughout the day but the casualties were fortunately not heavy. On several occasions swarms of German aeroplanes came out to reconnoitre and cruised about until driven off by our machines. During the afternoon the troops on our left made a second attack in the direction of GUEDECOURT. The only instructions received from the Brigade were one message to say that troops in the BROWN LINE would maintain their position, but might be called on to support an attack on the BLUE LINE by the 3RD Brigade. The troops in the GREEN LINE were ordered to be in Divisional Reserve under O.C. 2nd Battn. Grenadier Guards, these troops included about 150 men, under 2nd Lieut. T.F. McMAHON. After dark further consolidation was done and some wire was moved and put out in front of the portion of the BROWN LINE held, while the same covering party was sent out as on the previous night. We were warned of a probable counter-attack by the enemy, to take place at 2 A.M. but it did not materialise.	

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1st Battn Irish Guards.

Army Form C. 2118.

(15)

Place	Date 1916 SEPT.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	16TH		During the night, orders were received, that the Division would be relieved.	
	17th		Guides were sent back and No. 2 Company, The Lincoln Regiment, 62nd Brigade, arrived in two parties about 5.15 a.m. and 5.30 a.m. respectively. Their arrival was evidently observed in the early morning light and direct shell fire, in the midst of which a very rapid relief was effected with some difficulty. The various parties concentrated, as ordered, on the Southern edge of BIENVILLERS WOOD where the total strength of the Battalion, including 2nd Lieut. T. F. McMAHON's party, was found to be approximately 7 officers and other ranks, excluding the working platoon which rejoined the Battalion there, practically complete. The Battalion marched to Camp at "THE CITADEL" (F. 21.) arriving there about 9 a.m. with Drums Playing.	
			Casualties:— Major J. H. D. Bailie, Killed Lieut. C. R. Tisdall " 2nd Lieut. T. Butler "	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Battn Irish Guards

(16)

Place	Date SEPT. 1916	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near LES BOEUFS	17th		Capt. J. S. Long-Innes Wounded " R. Rankin ~ " ~ " C. Pease " ~ " ~ Died of Wounds. Lieut. & Capt. W. Innes ~ " ~ " H. C. Holmes ~ " ~ " Count J. E. de Salis ~ " ~ " H. R. Greer ~ " ~ Died of Wounds " W. Butler-Stoney ~ " ~ 2ND Lieut. D. J. Hegarty ~ " ~ " J. N. Watts ~ " ~ and 331 other ranks.	

2449 Wt. W14957/M90 750,000 1/16 J.B.C. & A. Forms/C.2118/12.

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WAR DIARY
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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Batt: Irish Guards (18)

Place	Date 1916	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
CITADEL Camp near CARNOY	20th SEPT		~~The Corps Comdr visited Batts and spoke of past & future operations~~ A further draft of ~~[illegible]~~ 101 Rnks joined. Weather still wet. The Batt'n together with the rest of the Brigade marched after dark, the 2 Coldstream Batts taking over front line trenches on the GINCHY ridge, 2/Bn Grenadiers in Reserve, 1st Bn Irish Gds in Support. The march was arduous, the ground being slippery and muddy: the area allotted consisted of old trenches & shell holes in and round the small rectangular wood on the E. edge of TRONES WOOD, where an uncomfortable night was spent. The new draft remained with Transport.
TRONES WOOD	21st		~~Shortly after~~ Considerable improvement in the weather. Moved in the evening into the N end of TRONES WOOD, to make room for the 6th Div which came in on our Right, where the shell holes were drier, & cover rather better. The draft joined the Batt'n from the Line Transport camps.
"	22nd		Remained in bivouacs: furnished carrying parties for the Batt'n in the line. Orders to move preparatory to attack were expected in the evening, but the ground being too heavy, everything was postponed 48 hours. Draft of 80 from Entrenching Batt'n reached Transport lines (worthy recs).

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Batn Irish Gds. (19)

Place	Date 1916 Sept	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
TROYES WOOD (1)	22nd (cont)		There was some shelling round the Northern end of the wood, which however did no damage. Casualties on fatigue parties 2 men wounded.	
"	23rd		Batn remained in its bivouacs & continued fatigue parties. Weather conditions very much improved. There was some shelling in the vicinity, but no casualties except Rev. H M Brown CF. who was hit in the face while visiting a neighbouring Battery. Lieut A St BLOM joined from Base.	
"	24th		Mass was celebrated in the wood by Father Casey. Several shells were put into the wood during the morning, causing Quite a number of casualties, mostly in No 1 Coy due to one shell. Total 2 killed & 13 wounded. (other ranks). All drafts had not reached the Batn, which was still however over 150 below strength, with only 12 officers all told. The Batn left the wood about 9-0 pm by Companies.	

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1st Battn Irish Guards

Army Form C. 2118.

(20)

Place	1916 Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
TRONES WOOD	24TH SEPT.	9pm.	Battalion left its bivouac in TRONES WOOD at 9PM. 24th and after a somewhat difficult march across the ground broken up by the action of the 15TH/16TH reached its Assembly Trenches about midnight, with a very few casualties. No 1 Coy (Captain J. R. Stargreaves) and No 2 Coy (Capt. Hon D. J. Ogilvy) were in the front line, the latter on the RIGHT, No 3 Company (Lieut A. H. Blom) and No 4 Company (Capt. A. J. P. Rodakowski) in a second line about 150 yards in rear, with Battalion Headquarters in a diagonal communication trench.	
	25TH		There was some shelling during the night and following morning, but the trenches being narrow casualties were not numerous, but unfortunately included 2nd J. C. Gibson who was hit during the march up and was replaced in No. 3 Coy by 2nd Lieut. J. F. McMahon, who had been left in reserve.	
			The task allotted to the Battalion was to take 3 objectives supported by the 3rd Battalion Coldstream Guards, who were to consolidate	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Battn. Irish Guards.

(21)

Place	Date 1916 SEPT.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
near LES BOEUFS	25TH 26.		the first objective and to send one Company in close support for the purpose of clearing the Northern part of LES BOEUFS village. The 2nd Battalion Grenadier Guards, supported by 2nd Battn Coldstream Guards had similar objectives including the main portion of the village, on our right, and on the left the 2nd Battalion Scots Guards were to take the 1st objective, after which the 1st Battalion Grenadier Guards were to go through them to the same line. Battalion orders were to secure the flanks of each objective above everything else, and these points were fortunately visible and clearly defined, excellent aeroplane photographs also being available. The hostile positions were steadily bombarded all the morning and during the previous day, and at 12:35 pm on 25th inst, a creeping barrage was put down, behind which Nos. 1 and 2 Coys. together with the whole line, advanced in two waves on the first objective. This was known as the GREEN LINE, and consisted of a complete single trench, with wire and half completed dug-outs, about 300 yards away; it was reached by the two Companies without much opposition and with very few	
		12:35pm		

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Battn Irish Guards

(22)

Place	Date 1916 SEPT.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near LES BOEUFS	25TH		casualties, but the Grenadiers, on the right, suffered severely owing to uncut wire. Immediately after the two Companies had advanced, a hostile barrage was put on our assembly trenches, which very much hampered Nos. 3 and 4 Coys. whose orders were to move into the front assembly trench under cover; there were a good many casualties including Capt. R J P RODAKOWSKI (Lieut. Mumford taking over No. 4 Coy.), and the Medical Officer. Eventually these Coys. got so held up by the shelling that they advanced "over the top" to the	
1pm			first objective, soon after 1pm.	
1:35pm			In accordance with programme, the advance was continued at 1:35pm by all 4 Companies, to the BROWN LINE, a sunken road on the West, or near side of LES BOEUFS, with the left flank thrown forward — this advance of about 500 yards, like the first was on a downward slope and again resistance was weak and casualties were not numerous— Lieut. BLOM had become a casualty at the first objective and 2nd Lieut. T F McMahon took Command of No. 3 Company.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Battn Irish Guards.

(23).

Place	Date 1916 SEPT.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near LES BOEUFS	25TH	1.45pm	Battalion Headquarters which had been rather broken up by the hostile barrage reached the GREEN LINE about 1.45pm immediately in front of No 4. Company, 3RD Battalion Coldstream Guards. On reaching the BROWN LINE the Companies came under shell fire from a Southerly direction, probably from some of our own guns, and there were a number of casualties.	
		2.15pm	This was reported by a Brigade message from Battalion Headquarters at 2.15pm., the capture of the BROWN LINE having been similarly notified at 1.50pm.	
		2.35pm	At 2.35pm., as per programme, the advance was continued, the 3RD and final objective (BLUE LINE) was on the far or EAST side of the village, and had been shewn on map as just EAST of another sunken road, this was also reached without great opposition, such clearing up of houses and dug-outs as was necessary being done by the Battalion as the 3RD Battn. Coldstream Guards Company had not quite closed up. The whole Battalion advanced about 100 yards beyond the sunken	

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WAR DIARY
or
~~INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY~~

(Erase heading not required.)

Army Form C. 2118.

1st Batt. Irish Guards.

(11)

Place	1916 Date SEPT.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
"CITADEL" Camp W. CARNOY	18th		Batt. remained in Camp, resting: the weather turned wet & cold. The following letter was received from the Brigadier, & subsequently read out on parade to the Batt.:— "As your Brigadier I wish to express my feelings as to your most gallant "work on the 15th Sept. 1916, in the operations at GINCHY. The advance "from the orchard in the face of machine gun fire is equal to anything "you have yet accomplished in this Campaign and once more the "1st Bn. Irish Guards has carried out a magnificent advance and held "ground gained in spite of the most severe losses. "In this your first campaign you are setting the highest possible standard "of bravery & efficiency for your successors and more praise than that "I cannot give you. "You may be called upon in the very near future to carry out similar "work & I know that you will not fail." (Sd) C. E. Pereira Brig/Gen. Comdg 1st Guards Brigade	
11	19th		Remained in Camp. Major T.M.D. Baillie's body was brought back & buried in the Camp Cemetery. A draft of 130 other ranks joined the Batt. The Division was warned for further operations in the immediate future.	

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WAR DIARY
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(Erase heading not required.)

1st Batt Irish Guards.

Army Form C. 2118.

(24)

Place	1916 Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near LES BOEUFS	25th SEPT.		Road, in accordance with the map and orders, and in order to get a field of fire we here they proceeded to dig in, and patrols were sent forward to keep in touch with the enemy who were visible in small parties, some of which surrendered. Unfortunately our creeping barrage appears to have stopped almost on the line on which the Companies were digging and it failed to lift forward for at least 15 minutes (this is the subject of a separate report) & during this time Capt. L. R. HARGREAVES was so severely wounded that he died while being carried back, and there were other casualties including Capt. DRURY-LOWE, Commanding the King's Coy, 1st Batt. Grenadier Guards, which was digging in on our left.	
			The 2nd Batt. Grenadier Guards were in line on the Right, though practically without any Company Officers left, but our left was still doubtful, except for the one weak Company of the 1st Batt. Grenadier Guards - subsequently, however, a defensive flank was formed by the 3rd Guards Brigade facing GUEDECOURT, where the attack had been held up.	
3 pm			Battalion Headquarters moved forward before 3 pm. to the BROWN LINE, and	

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WAR DIARY
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1st Batn Irish Guards.

Army Form C. 2118.

(25)

Place	Date 1916 SEPT	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near LES BOEUFS	25TH.		subsequently into a German dug-out on the road which formed that line. A Company of 3rd Batn. Coldstream Guards was moved up to help to secure the Left, and another Company in support of our line. Digging was continued throughout the afternoon and night, most of the hostile shelling being directed on the village and BROWN LINE. After dark our line was thinned by the withdrawal of No. 1 Coy. (under 2nd Lieut. S. L. SMITH) into the German dug-outs in the sunken road. A counter attack was launched during the afternoon against troops on our left, but was a complete failure, and the enemy infantry made no other attempt to molest us.	
	26TH.		The situation remained unchanged throughout the 26TH., shelling of the village and of the sunken road on the west side being almost continuous and being responsible for casualties amongst all 4 Battalions of the Brigade. In accordance with Corps orders 3 patrols were pushed forward during the afternoon towards the ridge about 500 yards distant, to endeavour to establish posts there, but although they went out with much gallantry they were held up by machine guns and snipers, and had to return after having casualties but	

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1st Battn Irish Guards

Army Form C. 2118.

(26)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Near LES BOEUFS	26TH SEPT.	9pm.	having located at least one machine gun At 9 pm the 2nd Battalion of the Regiment arrived and took over the whole village of LES BOEUFS from the Brigade, the Battalion returning via BERNAFAY WOOD to camp at "THE CITADEL" arriving there about 2.30 AM on the 17TH instant. Approximate casualties :- 1 officer Died of Wounds. 5 officers (including Medical officer) wounded. and some 230 casualties amongst "other ranks" The Battalion went into action under 600 strong (10 officers) including over 300 who had joined, in drafts, since the action of 15th/16th. Batt^n occupied different camps to the one occupied on 17th inst: and remained resting during the day. Messages of congratulation were received from the Corps Commander, 4th Army Commander, & the Brigadier Gen Comdg 2nd Guards Bde.	

T2134. Wt. W708—776. 500000. 4/15. Sir J. C. & S.

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Irish Guards.

29

Place	Date 1916 Sept	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
"CITADEL" camp nr CARNOY	27th (cont'd)		Bde was ordered to move during the afternoon to make room for the 5th Division, and marched to the 7th Fds Enthenching Bde Headquarters about 2 miles away, near FRICOURT, being played part of the way by the Band of the Rgt which was in camp. 2nd Lt R.B.S. REFORD joined Bde from the Base.	
near FRICOURT	28th		Remained in camp - weather very bad.	
	29th		Ordinary routine was resumed, as far as was possible after only 4 company offrs: 2nd Lt Mc Nairn having been sent with a party to a rest camp at AULT for a week.	
MORLANCOURT	30th		Marched in the afternoon to billets at MORLANCOURT, where the whole Brigade was also billeted. Captains The Earl of Kingston and H.T.A Boyce joined the Bde & assumed command of Nos 1 & 3, respectively.	

R McCalmont Lt Col
Comdg 1st Bn Irish Gds

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1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

1st BATTALION

IRISH GUARDS.

OCTOBER 1916

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October 1916

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1st Bde Irish Gds

Army Form C. 2118.

(1)

Vol 27

Place	Date 1916	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MORLAY COURT	1st		After Mass celebrated by a French Interpreter - Curé, the Bde marched about a mile to the main road, where the whole Brigade were "on-bussed" into some 140 French Army charabancs, at about 10-30 a.m: all arrangements being made by the French Army, the drivers being apparently ours military age & many of the assistants being natives. After a dusty drive of some 50 miles via AMIENS, the convoy arrived at HORNOY just before 6-0 p.m - (about 25 kilometres WSW of Amiens). The 1st Bn Irish Guards & Brigade machine gun Coy found excellent billets in Hornoy, the remaining Bns & Bde H.Q. marching to neighbouring villages (AUMONT, SELINCOURT & DROMESNIL).	
HORNOY	2nd		Spent in settling into billets: the inhabitants were exceptionally friendly & anxious to make Officers & men comfortable.	
	3rd		Owing to small numbers & many stragglers, Officers were in one mess. The 1st Line Transport arrived during the evening after a 3 days march.	
			The Bns began to settle down to regular training - chiefly drill.	
			2nd Lts J. J. V. Fitz W. MURPHY and J. N. NASH joined from the Base.	
			A Church Service (in Commemoration of the recent actions) was held: Mass also in the Church.	

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WAR DIARY
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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Batt Irish Guards

(2)

Place	Date 1916 Oct	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	4th		Training - Rev. R. J. LANE-FOX CF joined for duty.	
	5th		2nd Lt Hon D. O'BRIEN joined from the Base, with a draft of 152 OR. Major Gen. G. Fielding CB DSO Comdg 1st Division addressed the Batt: on parade complimenting it on its work on Sept 15th, 16th, 25th + 26th: he also presented ribbons to NCOs + men awarded medals.	
	6th		Training continued - 2nd Lt Hon D O'Brien went down sick.	
O	7th		2nd Lt E. BUDD (also 5 OR) joined from the Base - Training continued.	
C	8th		Mass + Church of England Services -	
T			a Rugby football match was played against a neighbouring French Recruit Batt: by a scratch team chiefly composed of officers.	
O			a Dinner attended by about 50 officers, was held at 1st Bde Hd Qrs — DROMESNIL. 2nd Lt D E BROWNE joined from Base	
B	9th		Training continued — chiefly drill + Company training -	
E	10th			
R	11th			
	12th		Lt Col R McCalmont proceeded on leave, Capt Earl of Kintore assuming Command	

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WAR DIARY
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1st Batt. Irish Guards (3)

Place	Date 1916 OCT	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	13th		2nd Lt E.M. HARVEY with a draft of 95 OR from the Base: 11 OR had also rejoined in small parties since the 4th inst. Training continued:-	
	14th		Company training, Bombing & Lewis Gun training &c-	
	15th		Usual services.	
O	16th		Training of Companies, Bombers & Lewis Gunners.	
N	17th			
	18th			
	19th		Major Hon T.E. VESEY joined as 2nd in Command, from home, & assumed command. Capt R.G.C. VERBURGH rejoined from Central Training School, Havre, & was posted to command No 4 Coy. 2nd Lieuts A.L. BAIN, H.H. MAXWELL & P.J. KANE joined from Base.	
O			Training as before.	
	20th		Training continued as before:-	
22	21st			
	22nd		Usual Sunday services.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Batt Irish Guards

(4)

Place	Date 1916 OCT.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	23rd		After Company training, the Batt joined the 2nd Batt of the Regt for dinners about midway between the two billets which were some 5 miles apart. A football match was subsequently played (won by 1st Batt) & an enjoyable day spent.	
	24th		Lt Col R. McCalmont rejoined from leave & resumed Command. Training continued as before.	
	25th		Usual training in the morning. The Band of the Regt played in the village in the afternoon, and many of all ranks of the 26th French Regt attended.	
	26th		2nd Lt D A B MOODIE joined with 50 OR from the Base, small drafts of 25 during the previous 10 days bringing up the Batt to some 40 over Strength. Lieut H F S LOWS rejoined from Intelligence Duties (9th Corps). Training continued.	
	27th		Company & other Special training as before.	
	28th		Batt Outpost Scheme	

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1st Batt Irish Guards

(5)

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Place	Date 1916 OCT	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	29th		Usual Sunday services -	
	30th		Batt. Attack Scheme & other training.	
	31st		Divisional rehearsal of Review for HRH The Duke of Connaught.	

List of Decorations awarded during the month.

for 15th Sept. Military Cross — Capt L R. Hargreaves (killed 25th) -
Capt P. S. Longstaffe 2nd Lt. G. V. Williams -
D.C. Medal - Drill Sergt Moran (died of wounds) & Pte Boyd.
Bar to " " " - Sergt. Riordan (wounded & reported missing)
Military Medals - L/Cpl J Carroll, Ptes M. Kenny, J. O'Connor, J White J. Rochford & L/Cpl Connors.

for 25th Sept. Military Cross - Lt (Temp. Capt) Hon P. Ofeley
Bar to D.C.M. - Sergt (A/CSM) McMillan -
Military Medals - Sergt W Fegbery, L/Sgt McKeyan, L/Cpl Dollar, Ptes Wheatly, Pte Troy & Pte M. Lewis

for 15th & 25th Military Cross - Lieut Mumford, & 2nd Lt J.F. McMahon.
Military Medals - Sergt P. Doolan, Pte G. Taylor.
A Captured German machine Gun of the 15th inst. was also presented to the Batt.

R. McCalmont Lt Col
Comdg 1st Bn Irish Guards

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1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

1st BATTALION

IRISH GUARDS.

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1st Batt. Irish Guards

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Place	Date 1916 NOV	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
HORNOY	1st		The Guards Division (less Cavalry & Artillery) was inspected by HRH The Duke of Connaught (Senior Colonel of the Brigade of Guards), on parade near DROMESNIL after inspection in lines of Battalions in Close Column of Half Companies, HRH addressed representatives of every unit (those who had received medals), & the Division subsequently marched past in Column of fours.	Speech published in Regt. orders.
	2nd 3rd 4th 5th 6th 7th 8th		Company & Batt. training continued. Drill Sergt J. ORR assumed duty as 2nd Lt from 2nd Nov.	
			Usual Church Services. An Association football match against a 26th French Inf. Regt. team was played in the afternoon. After a route march the Comdg Officer & Company Commanders rode over to see the 26th French Infantry Regt. practise an attack in the latest form. Preparations for move back to the line were commenced.	
			The 1st Line Transport marched, in order to join the Batt. on arrival 3 days later. An officers dinner for both 1st & 2nd Batts. which had been arranged for this night was carried through despite the departure of the Transport. Brig.-Gen. Hon. L. Butler (Comdg 60th Inf. Bde) & 13 officers of the 2nd Batt. attended, the dinner being held in the Hotel Lion d'Or, Hornoy, about 34 diners in all.	

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WAR DIARY
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INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY
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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Batt. Irish Guards

(2)

Place	Date 1916 NOV	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
HORNOY	9th		All wheeled transport being already on the road, this was practically an idle day.	
	10th		Batt. paraded about 8.30 am & marched to the Eastern outskirts of the village in which all ranks had enjoyed a pleasant month amongst people who were most hospitable. A convoy of French Army motor buses took the Battalion via Amiens to TREUX in about 6 hours: thence by march route through MEAULTE to the Citadel Camp, about 1 mile SW of CARNOY: these places being familiar to those who were with the Batt. in Aug & Sept. The Camp was nearly all bell-tents, in a sea of mud, & the weather cold: arrived after dark, the rolling transport arriving about the same time by march route.	
CARNOY "Citadel" Camp				
MONTAUBAN	11th		marched in the morning via MAMETZ to MONTAUBAN, where a Sort of Camp was taken over on the S side of the village from 8th S Staffs Regt. The accomodation was quite inadequate, but with the addition of some half finished huts, cover was found for all ranks before dark. All roads & tracks were deep in mud & conditions generally very poor.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Batt. Irish Guards.

(3)

Place	Date 1916 Nov	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MONTAUBAN – GUEDECOURT.	12th		Mass was said in the open air & there was an Evening Church of England service. A few shells were dropped in the neighbourhood during the afternoon and about 9 into the Camp itself during the early morning, but without causing casualties in the Batt.n.	
	13th		Moved in the afternoon to take over trenches between LES BOEUFS & GUEDECOURT, across the ground over which the Batt.n fought on 15th Sept.r. A long line of "duck-boards" led from E edge of TRONES WOOD, right over the FLERS ridge to "NEEDLE DUMP" (about 1000^{x} NW of LESBOEUFS) When Batt. H^{d} Qrs occupied a deep dug out. (N 33 d 2.1) The Right front Coy (no 4) took over from 7th Yorkshire Regt from N 28 d 5.5 to N 28 d 1.7 & the remainder from 8th S. Staffordshire Regt, no 2 Coy on the Left, no 3 in Support & no 1 in Reserve (behind Batt. H^{d} Qrs).	Sheet 57 c
			The march was lengthy, but the weather though cold had turned dry: & the relief was complete before midnight, despite considerable shelling. The trenches were quite unconnected & communication most difficult owing to the absence not only of Communication trenches but also landmarks. There was also an almost complete absence of trench-boards, wire &c, & everything had to be brought from GINCHY either by hand or on pack animals.	
			Casualty – 1 man wounded	
			Major Hon.ble E. VESEY was evacuated sick, as the result of old wounds	

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INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY

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1st Batt Irish Guards

Place	Date RPG NOV	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches & Quebecourt	14th		Weather continued very cold, but dry, & a good deal of work was done in the darkness, as regards deepening & improving of trenches. Shelling was Continuous but indiscriminate, and the Line was otherwise quiet except in the front Line where ordnies were under fire: this was the cause of several Casualties including one man who was subsequently reported as having been killed through crossing to the German Line in front of 2nd Bn Scots Guards. Casualties — 4 Other ranks wounded & 3 missing.	Capt A BOYSE proceeded to Base for duty at C.T. School, Havre.
	15th		A similar day to the 14th., in the Line. A wounded German surrendered to No 4 Coy, & considerable difficulty was found in evacuating him & our own wounded, owing to the long "carry" not only to Batt HQrs, but on to the Dressing St.	
	16th		After another similar day to the two previous ones, the Batt. was relieved after dark by the 2nd Bn Canadian Guards: & it should be here explained that the 12 Batts of the Div. were divided into 2 groups, the 1st Bn Coldstream & 2nd Bn Irish Guards being added to form the Right Group, of which the Coldstream were on the Right. 4th Batt. Canadian Guards being the adjoining Batt on the Left. Relief was Complete by midnight but the Batt was not clear until the early morning. Casualties — 2 OR killed & 9 wounded.	
			Casualties — 1 OR killed & 5 wounded.	

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1st Bat. Irish Guards. (5)

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Place	Date 1916 Nov	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
'H' Camp N of CARNOY	17th		Bat. arrived at Camp 'H' between CARNOY & MONTAUBAN: only one "Nissen" hut (accomodation 30) being available per platoon, but in the bitter cold weather 40 men per hut were not too many.	
	18th		Usual inspections. Bitter weather, with some snow.	
	19th		Sunday services in huts. Weather broke during the night.	
	20th		2nd Lt T. R. DAMES-LONGWORTH joined Bat. from Base. Bat. moved to "Sandpits" camp, about ¾ mile S of MEAULTE, along the road to BRAY, where all ranks were under canvas in bell tents.	
"Sandpits" Camp, S. of MEAULTE.	21st		Bat. remained at "Sandpits Camp" where some drill was possible in frosty weather & considerable work done to improve the camp. One Company was gradually moved to new huts about ¼ mile away.	
	22nd			
	23rd			
	24th			
	25th		Usual Mass & Church of England Services, ten in Camp. Weather very wet.	
	26th		This being the day arranged for an Irish Guards Requiem Mass in Westminster Cathedral, a Requiem Mass was said in MEAULTE Church which was attended by parties from 1st & 2nd Bdes Machine Gun Coys, & a few officers of 2nd Bat. in addition to 400 of the Bat.	
	27th			

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Army Form C. 2118.

(6)

1st Batt. Irish Guards.

Place	Date 1916 NOV	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
1½ miles N. of BRAY "Forked-tree" Camp	27th (contd)		In preparation for the taking over of some line from the French, the Batt. + 3 others moved about 1½ further South & took over a "Forked tree" Camp, consisting of 60 French huts accomodating 100 each - Accomodation was simple, but Cook houses, Latrines etc. all required building as the camp was unfinished.	
	28th		Lieut. Hon H. B. O'BRIEN employed as Brigade Bombing Officer, was appointed Staff Captain 1st Guards Brigade, from this date. Both the Corps and Divisional Commanders visited the Camp. Usual routine of training & improvement work.	
	29th		Capt R. G. C. YERBURGH left the Batt. for attachment to 2nd Guards Brigade HQrs for instruction in Staff duties. Brigadier inspected the Camp - Usual training, including 2 Coy Route marches.	
	30th		Same routine as for 29th.	

P. le Fanu Lt Col
Cmdg 1st Bn Irish Guards

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1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

1st BATTALION

IRISH GUARDS.

DECEMBER 1916

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1st Bn Irish Guards.

December 1916

Vol 29

Place	Date 1916	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	Dec. 1st 2nd		The Bn is FORKTREE CAMP about 1½ miles N of BRAY. This Camp consisted of large huts taken over from the French.	
	3rd		Bn marched off about 11 am via BRAY — ~~MA~~ BRONFAY FARM — MARICOURT — HARDICOURT, by platoons to MALTZ HORN CAMP, which consisted of French tents. This Camp is about 240 yds S of TRONES WOOD.	
	4th 5th		The Bn remained at MALTZ HORN CAMP, whilst arrangements were made for taking over a sector of line from the French.	
	6th		Bn took over as the RIGHT SECTOR of the Guards Div from the 160th REGT of the 20th CORPS (CORPS de FER.) The line consisted for the Bn of about 1000 yds frontage. Our right at U 14 b 6.3 at the S.E of SAILLY SAILLISEL to our left at U 8 b 1.2 the N.E corner of SAILLY-SAILLISEL. The 156th REGT (French) was on our right. A COLDSTREAM Bn on our left. As in our last sector of line, the DIVISION was divided into 2 GROUPS. the 1st Bn COLDSTREAM Gds and the 2nd Bn IRISH Gds being added to the 1st GUARDS Bde for this purpose. Lt Col. R. McCalmont proceeded to LONDON in connection with Parliamentary Crisis,	

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Army Form C. 2118.

(2)

1st Bn Irish Guards

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	Dec 6th 1916		Major E.B. Greer M.C. from 2nd Bn IRISH GDS took over Temporary command pending the arrival of CAPT HONble N.R. Alexander. DSO. M.C. The Bn marched about 5 p.m. via GUILLEMONT — COMBLE — Bois de la HAIE, where French guides met each Platoon. The Bn was disposed as follows. No1 RIGHT FRONT. No 3 LEFT FRONT. No 2 coy in Support about 150 yds ~~of the~~ in rear of the RIGHT FRONT COY. No 4 coy in Reserve at the QUARRY. (U 13 a 2.6.) The line was taken over from the French Regimental Commander, who handed over both Bn Sectors at the CHATEAU, after which Bn H.Q. moved back to the QUARRY. The ~~relief~~ excellent French arrangements resulted in the most successful relief which was completed by 11.30 pm, without casualties.	
	7th		The line was in a very bad condition owing to the wet. The front line was not continuous, but held in places. There was French wire out along the whole front, but no bark. The Support line which runs through the houses of the village was fairly good and drier. A few dugout cellars to shelter the men.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

(3)

1st Bn Irish Guards.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	Dec 7th 1916.		There were no communications or road up to the SUPPORT LINE, so the going was very heavy. H.Q. at the QUARRY consisted of dug-outs made in the sides of the QUARRY and shafts run in to the chalk.	
		— 8th	Throughout the whole tour the Germans were very quiet — no sniping or artillery fire except when the enemy became frightened and suspected a relief, then he put down a very unpleasant barrage just behind our support line and about the CHATEAU.	
		— 9th	Relieved by the 2nd Bn GRENADIER GUARDS. Owing to the exceptionally heavy state of the ground, the relieving Bn had great difficulty in reaching the front system, being constantly delayed in digging men out of the mud. Although the relief left Bois de la HAIE about 5.15 pm — the relief was not completed until 1.30 AM. (10th) During the relief a few shells were sent over and 2 of our men were killed, including Sgt Wyllie. Casualties 8 wounded 2 killed (just stated)	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn Irish Guards.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	Dec 9th 1916		On relief the Bn returned to MALTZ HORN CAMP. Capt HON. A.H.R. Alexander D.S.O. M.C took over temporary command and Major E.B. Greer M.C returned to the 2nd Bn Irish Guards. CAPT. R.V. Pollock joined from home and took command of No 1 coy.	
	10th		About 2 pm the Bn marched to CAMP H. this camp is built of Nissen huts and gave good shelter. The camp itself was very muddy. It is situated about 1 mile S.W of MONTAUBAN.	
	11th		Captain Earl of Kingston proceeded this day to hospital, due to his old wound.	
	12th		1 pm the Bn marched to COMBLES via GUILLEMONT. Coys were disposed of as follows. No 4 coy HIGHWOOD (Bois de la Haie) No 3 COMBLES. No 1 and No 2 COMBLES TRENCH. Bn Hq. in an old gunpit dug-out at the West end of COMBLES. the Bn came into support for the RIGHT GROUP in this area. accommodation very bad. 50 men from the Bn were required for fatigues, carrying material and building new lines.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn Irish Guards.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	Dec 13th 1916.		Bn went into the line, taking over from 2nd Bn Irish Guards. Guides met platoons at the CHATEAU at 5 pm and the whole relief was completed by between 7 and 8 pm. The way up to the CHATEAU from HALEWOOD head now been much improved by laying down trench boards. The Bn was disposed as follows in the line. RT front No 4 coy — left front no 2 coy — support no 1 coy and reserve coy no 3 coy. The sapping platoon was put in to the Corps. 2nd Lt V. Fitzhr. Murphy then days hospital suffering from exposure.	
	14th		The ground had become a little dried and it was possible this tour to get some good work done in the front line. This was accomplished by making strong points in the front line, by laying down trench boards, revetting the parapet, and wiring strongly in front. The sapping platoon did good work on making a corduroy road from the PECONNE ROAD up to the support line. There was very little sniping or artillery fire during this tour, both sides being only able to reach their front line by going over the open.	
	15th		Relieved by the 2nd Bn Grenadier Guards. A good relief completed by 7.15 pm. Bn marched back to MALTZ HOEK CAMP. Total casualties 11 wounded.	

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Army Form C. 2118. (6)

1st Bn. Irish Guards.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	Dec 16th		11 am the Bn entrained at TRONES WOOD SIDING and went by rail to PLATEAU SIDING. Detrained there and marched to CAMP 10B BRONFAY. This camp was very bad — several hundred gunners in it already. By agreement 2 huts were handed over to the artillery, and 6 huts were kept for the Bn. i.e 5½ huts for coys, ½ hut for officers. H.Q stayed at Q.M hut a short way off. The quartermaster procured fuel and braziers and the men were made fairly comfortable under a difficult situation. The muddle was due to no proper arrangements being made to find out from whom Camp 10B belonged, before Bns were moved into it.	
	17th		Men rested and did their best to dry and clean their clothes. Usual inspections carried out.	
	18th.		Bn moved from Camp about mid-day, entrained at PLATEAU SIDING — detrained at TRONES WOOD and marched to the COMBLES AREA via GUILLEMONT. Coys were disposed of as before, except coys were changed over. Usual fatigues were found. Bn Hq. moved to a house in COMBLES called the "TÊTE de BOEUF", so-called because of a Bull's head which hung on a tree outside. weather still bad.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn Irish Guards.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	Dec 19th 1916.		Relieved the 2nd Bn Irish Guards in the front system. Passed HAIEWOOD 4 pm — relief completed by 6.45 pm.	
	20th		Fine frosty weather. Much improvement could be effected in the trenches during this spell, and tracks, floorboarded were made. During the whole of this tour there was very little to report, enemy activity, except aircraft being below normal.	
	21st		Relieved by the 2nd Grenadiers. A successful relief completed by 6.45 pm. The Bn marched to TREONES WOOD and detrammy at PLATEAU SIDING reached CAMP 10C BRONFAY between 12 and 1 AM. Total casualties for tour 5 wounded, 1 killed.	
	22nd		Day spent in cleaning and inspections much improvement had been effected at this camp. The Bn been allotted 11 huts. Lt Col R. McCalmont reported the Bn this day	
	23rd		Rest Day in Camp.	

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1st Bn Irish Guards.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	Dec	24th	About midday the Bn moved into the COMBLES area, going by train from PLATEAU SIDING to TROYES WOOD and thence marching from thence to COMBLES. Except for inter-change between Coys the Bn was disposed as before except as to which coy was now placed in the intermediate line — a line 300 yds N of HALE WOOD or more. Capt Alexander was left behind this tour together with Lt Mackenzie who had previously sprained his knee.	
	Dec	25th	Bn moved into the line and relieved the 2nd Grenadier Guards IRISH GUARDS. Quiet relief without any incidence to report.	
		26th	During the day, owing to Brig Gen. C. Pereira going to command the 2nd Div, Lt Col R.C. McCalmont took over temp: command of the 1st Gds Bde, whilst Captain H.P. Alexander took over temp: command of the Bn.	
		27th	Weather very wet; and consequently much damage done to the trenches by the rain.	

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1st Bn Irish Guards

9

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	Dec 27th 1916		Quiet day with very little sniping or shelling. By 7 pm the Bn was relieved by the 2nd Bn Grenadier Guards marched to TROYES WOOD, entrained to PLATEAU SIDING and got back to CAMP 10 at about 1 AM. Casualties for tour 4 wounded.	
	Dec 28th } 29th }		Quiet day for the men, spent in resting and cleaning up.	
	30th		Moved up to the COMBLE area by the same method as previously, but started later, to make the march shorter, as no train was available. COMBLES, as no train was available. As usual were found in this area.	
	31st		Brig Gen. J. Jeffreys took over command of 1st Guards Bde. Lt Col R.C. McCalmont took over command of 1st Bn which relieved the 2nd Bn Irish Guards in the trenches, this night. The relief was completed by 7.45 pm without any casualties. The new year was seen in, without incidence.	

R.C. McCalmont Lt Col
Cmdg 1st Bn Irish Guards

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bat Irish Guards

January 1917

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Place	Date JAN Y	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches at SAILLY-SAILLISEL	1st		A quiet day in the trenches — one man wounded.	
	2nd		Batt was relieved after dark by 1st Bn Somerset L.I. (20th Div) and returned to previous Camp at BROMFAY FARM 10S, marching to TROISVES WOOD SIDING where there was a long wait for trucks. Batt consequently did not arrive in Camp until the early morning of	
6 D. MEMY FM. 118.	3rd	3 pm	and. Early in the afternoon marched again to billets at Sandpits Camp, MEAULTE.	
MEAULTE	4th 5th 6th 7th 8th 9th		Remained at MEAULTE: rest & usual routine. Cold weather. Lt F.S.L. SMITH — 2nd Lt J.J. KANE transferred to 2nd Batt. ordered to shorter — to Batt due to Sickness.	
	10th		Marched via VILLE — TREUX to MERICOURT-L'ABBÉ: To billets.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Batt. Irish Guards

(2)

Place	Date 1917 JAN	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
ST PIERRE CAPPEL	11th		The Division took over a new Sector of the line opposite ST PIERRE VAAST WOOD about this date, with one Brigade only holding the line, & the 1st Guards Brigade became Reserve at Meaulte, Ville & Mericourt-l'abbé. Billets were fairly good, but poor for officers. One company permanently employed on a fatigue at the Railway Stn.	
	12th		No 4 Coy proceeded to the Briqueterie just S of BERNAFAY WOOD to furnish permanent fatigue of 100 on Decauville Railway construction. Regular drill & training of Specialists was started.	
MERICOURT	13th		Routine as usual & improvement of billets.	
	14th		Mass in Church of England Service with 2nd Bn Royal Fusrs.	
	15th			
	16th		Normal Training routine.	
	[illegible]			
	17th		Christmas dinners were held for Nos 2 & 3 Coys in a large Cinema Hall. The Band of the Welsh Guards played in the hall at the dinners. Coys	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Batt Irish Guards. (3)

Place	Date 1915 JAN	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
L'ARBRET	18th		No 3 Coy relieved No 4 at BRIQUETERIE. Other Training routine as usual.	Captain R V POLLOK wounded to 2nd Batt as 2nd in Command.
	19th		Nothing special to record.	
	20th		Christmas dinners for Nos 1 & 4 under the same arrangements as for the other Companies. Weather turned very wintry.	
			Some cases of 'contagious stomatatis' appeared amongst the transport horses. The Corps Commander visited Batt HQrs.	
			A Sergeants dinner was held in the evening.	
	21st		Usual Mass & Church Services. Practically all transport horses were infected with Stomatatis, & were taken to their complete isolation.	
	22nd		Lt Col H Calvert proceeded to attend Senior officers course at 4th Army Infantry School & in the absence on leave of other senior officers, Capt. P H. Nicholson assumed Command.	
	23rd		Normal Training routine.	
	24th			
	25th			
	26th			

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Batt. Irish Guards

(4)

Place	Date 1917 JAN.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
BILLON FARM CAMP.	27th		Batt. marched to Camp 107 at BILLON FARM, S of CARNOY: arriving in time for late dinners = No 3 Coy having already arrived. H.Qrs in an old French dugout, remainder in by French huts. Captain A. BOYSE having rejoined from Central training School, Havre, assumed Command of the Batt. All Transport was left at Mericourt l'Abbé for isolation, & attached for rations to 3rd Bde Grenadier Guards.	
	28th 29th 30th		Usual training routine in Continued bad weather.	
	31st		Usual training - Lt Col R McCalmont returned from Course & resumed command.	
			Training as before.	

R McCalmont
Lt Col
Comdg 1st Bn Irish Guards

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February 1917 — Army Form C. 2118.

1st Batt Irish Guards. (1)

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Place	Date 1917 FEB	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
BILLON FM	1st		Batt at BILLON FM Camps (107), about 1 mile S of CARNOY. Ordinary routine. Weather cold & bright, with snow on the ground. The 1st Guards Brigade in Divisional Reserve, 3 Batts at BILLON and one in forward area.	
PRIEZ FARM	2nd	9.0 am	By march route via MARICOURT – HARDECOURT – MAUREPAS to relieve 3rd Batt Coldstream Guards at PRIEZ FARM, W of RANCOURT: No 2 Coy was left under canvas at MAUREPAS RAVINE, and the remainder in dugouts and shelters. There were several small standing R.E. fatigues to be taken over & the 3rd Bn Coldstream marched off by 12.15 p.m. A very few small shells were fired into the area during the afternoon, one of which unluckily 2nd Lt (temp. Captain from this date) J ORR + 2 men. He had been in temporary command of No 1 Coy since 18.1.17: 2nd Lt D.S. BROWNE assumed command.	
	3rd		A quiet day in the same area – No change in the weather.	
	4th		Another quiet day, little work being possible owing to the hard ground, except for a carrying party of 100 and Tunnelling Coy fatigues	
	5th		Quiet day: a few small shells did no damage.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn Irish Guards. (2)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
BILLON CAMP	6th	6th	Left FRIEZ FARM. about mid-day, relieved by the 2nd Bn COLDSTREAM GUARDS. The Bn marched via MARCOVET to Camp 16 - BILLON.	
		7th	The Bn went into DIVISIONAL RESERVE.	
		8th	General routine. The weather was exceptionally cold, but fine.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn Irish Guards (3)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
BILLON	Feb 8th 1917		Major Alexander returned from leave.	
	9th		Lt Col R.C. McCalmont DSO and Father Lane Fox proceeded on leave.	
	10th		The Bn in divisional Reserve at Camp 16 – BILLON.	
	11th		Weather very cold and frosty.	
	12th		Marched to MAUREPAS RAVINE. Left BILLON CAMP at 8.30 AM and marched via MARICOURT and HARDICOURT. MAUREPAS CAMP X consisted of tents and a few NISSEN HUTS — situated about 500 yds west of MAUREPAS.	
MAUREPAS.	13th		General routine in camp.	
	14th		In this camp the Bn was in Brigade Reserve.	
	14th		Capt R. Baggally M.C. joined the Bn this day.	
	15th		The Bn took over a piece of the front line opposite ST PIERRE VAAST WOOD just North of RANCOURT. Relieved the 2nd Bn GRENADIER GUARDS in the line. Front line held by 2 coys, consisting of 10 posts and 3 advanced posts. with 4 posts in support These posts held about a section. 2 coys in Reserve.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn Irish Guards.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Front Line	15th to 19th		The Bn remained four days in the line, after 2 days the corps in Reserve relieved the corps in the front line. During the four the line was very quiet, practically no sniping at all, and very occasional shelling. On 16th the adjutant Captain A.L. Gordon M.C returned from leave. The first meeting the 16th, but little work could be done as regards digging owing to the hard state of the ground.	add Capt. R.T.P Rodakowske arrived on 17/2/17 from Base.
	19th		Relieved by the 2nd Bn Grenadier Guards. The Bn marched back via COMBLES to MAUREPAS. All corps were in by about 10 pm. Total casualties during this tour. 3 killed, 5 wounded.	
CAMP X MAUREPAS	20th to 22nd		Weather wet. General routine in camp 1½ day cleaning, inspections, baths etc Drill, physical exercise etc. following days.	
	23rd		Left Camp at 4.30 pm and marching via COMBLES, met guides at PRIEZ FARM 6 pm. Relieved 2nd Bn Grenadier Guards in the line. All relief completed successfully by 8 pm.	
LINE	24th		Owing to the latter state of the ground, work could be carried on, digging etc. Two very good officer patrols went out at 9 pm One under	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn Irish Guards. (3)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	25th (cont)		2Lt SHEARS with an N.C.O and 3 bombers and 3 Bayonet men left our front line. FRONT LINE. four posts in the LEFT FRONT COY. They proceeded to the GERMAN WIRE and reconnoitred the enemy line & found out how strongly it was held. They were bombed and sniped, but returned safely over their own line about 11.30 pm.	
			The 2nd patrol of the same strength left our lines in the RIGHT FRONT COY, under Lt BROWN. They were at once seen and fired on, but returning left our lines further to the south. They advanced to the GERMAN wire, and finding a weak spot, cut their way through it. They reached within a few yards of the enemy's parapet when they were heavily bombed. They used up all their own supply and having 4 men and the officer wounded (slightly) returned. Both these patrols were congratulated by the Brigade on their enterprise and excellent reports. Lt BROWN admitted to hospital this day.	
	26th.		The Bn, owing to the success & suspected retirement of the enemy, were ordered to make full arrangements for a raid, and provided it things went well, to occupy 200 yds of the enemy's line from U 26 a 5.6 — U 26 a 6.4. (map ref. COMBLES 57 C S.W. 1. 10/000). Everything was completed, but the raid was cancelled.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn Irish Guards. (6)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Front Line		27th	The Bn was relieved in the line by the 3rd Bn GRENADIER GUARDS. Relief completed by 8.45 pm During this tour, the weather held fairly good and considerable work was carried out on the posts and communication trenches. There was no shelling, but a good deal of artillery fire in the way of hostile barrages, which were let down on our lines nearly every evening between 6 and 8 pm. Total Casualties during this tour. 2 killed. 13 wounded one officer wounded.	
MAUREPAS.			The Bn returned to MAUREPAS for one night, where Lt-Col R.C. McCALMONT D.S.O. reformed Battalion.	
BILLON	28th		The Bn left camp x about 10 AM and marching via HARBONNIERES, and MARLECOURT reached CAMP 16, BILLON about midday.	

R. McCalmont Lt-Col
Comdg 1st Bn Irish Gds

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March 1917. Army Form C. 2118. (1.)

1st Bn Irish Guards.

Vol 32

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
BILLON CAMP	March 1917			
	1st		General routine. 2nd Lieut A L. BAIN proceeded to XIV Corps School at MEAULTE this day — Lieut E.H. SHEARS also to G.H.Q. Lewis gun school at LE TOUQUET	
	2nd		General routine in camps — weather wet and cold.	
	3rd		Lt Col R.C.A. McCALMONT left in a motor to take over command of the 3rd INF. BDE just South of the SOMME. The Bn gave him a tremendous send off.	
			MAJOR HON CE N.R. ALEXANDER D.S.O. M.C took over command of the Bn from this date.	
	4th		~~Training and~~, ordinary Church Services.	
	5th		Training and general routine	
	6th		MAJOR G.E.S. YOUNG came from the 2nd Bn IRISH GUARDS to take over the duties of 2nd in Command. 2nd Lieut A.L. BAIN reported the Bn from XIV corps School	

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Army Form C. 2118.

(2)

1st Bn Irish Guards.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
FREGICOURT.	MARCH 1917			
	7th to 11th		General routine in camp — weather varied from rain to fairly fine days. Open warfare was practiced by companies — the use of strong patrols, lectures to N.C.Os and compass lectures to Officers, and practice in compass and map reading. On 10th a practice attack on 3 lines of trenches was carried out with the 2nd Bn COLDSTREAM GUARDS — the creeping barrage was represented by the drums of the two Bns. This exercise was very successfully carried out.	
	12th		Left camp about 3 pm and marching via MARICOURT-HARDICOURT and MAUREPAS reached FREGICOURT where the Bn came into Brigade Reserve. Bn HQ in FREGICOURT. one company in COMBLES — two coys ~~into kind~~ in HAIE WOOD and one company in FREGICOURT.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn Irish Guards

(3)

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
In the line at SAILLISEL	March 1917. 13th		6 pm Bn left its billets and proceeded to SAILLISEL where we took over the line held by the 4th Bn GRENADIER GUARDS. No 2 and 4 companies were in the front line. No 1 and No 3 Coy in support. The line was very bad and only consisted of small posts in a very bad condition. No 1 and No 2 Coys were in quite good trenches.	
	14th		Orders were received from the Bde that it was probable the Germans would retire from their front line. Orders were issued by the Bn and the two front Coys patrolled actively throughout the night. Noticeable for good patrols were Lt F BUDD and Lt BAGNALL. About midnight the whole of the GERMAN front line was reported unoccupied by the enemy and entirely occupied by our strong patrols — while reconnoitring patrols pushed out in front.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st B.n Irish Guards. (4)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	March 1917			
	15th		At 10 am the advance was commenced. The 1st objective given was GOTHA Trench, the final objective given was a line drawn from U 16 a 3.2 to U 10 a 2.3. (Map ref. COMBLES 1:10,000.) No 4 coy was left front coy. No 2 coy right front coy No 4 coy was ordered to find the advanced company with No 2 coy in support — followed by No 1 coy. The boundary as shown in blue on the map. By 11 am the Bn had reached BAYREUTH TRENCH but came under fairly heavy machine gun fire, and a heavy artillery fire. This line (BAYREUTH) was now consolidated, being in touch on left with the 2nd Coldstream Guards and in touch on the right by patrols with the 2nd Bn Irish Guards.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st B.n Irish Guards

5

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	15th March (cont) 1917		On this day MAJ G.E.S YOUNG was seriously wounded this day when visiting No 2 coy HQ at U 4 D 9.5. a shell coming through the roof. Lt M.C. MUMFORD M.C. was wounded by a small piece of shell in the lip.	
	15/16th		Strong patols were sent out from BAYREUTH ~~GOTHA~~ TRENCH to GOTHA TRENCH and finding it unoccupied by the enemy held and consolidated it by small posts	
	16th		No 4 and part of No 2 coy moved forward into this trench and consolidated it. No 2 coy on the right No 4 on the left. The hostile shelling was again very severe during the day.	
	16th/17th		Reconnoitring patrols were sent out by the two front coys as far as FERDINAND TRENCH and STAR CROSS ROAD at U 10 C 9.4. Enemys evacuation reported.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn Irish Guards.

(6)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	March 17th	1917.	at 6 AM two posts were established in front RT post consisting of 1 section and a Lewis gun team from No 2 coy at U 10 C 7. 1 and Left post consisting of 1 section and 1 Lewis gun team from No 4 coy at U 10 C 3. 6.	
			The patrolling for both these coys was done by Lt E. BUDD (No 2) and Lt. R. BAGENALL (No 4)	
			The day except for very occasional sniping from along distance was quiet.	
			The Bn was relieved this night. The two advanced posts and No 2 and No 4 coys in GOTHA and BAYREUTH TRENCH were relieved by one company of the 8th Bn COLDSTREAM GUARDS No 1 coy in our old front line from U 14 d 10.0 — U 14 d 6.5 and No 3 coy at BULLET CROSS ROADS about U 13 were relieved by 2 coys of the 2nd Bn Grenadier Guards.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn Irish Guards (7)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MAUREPAS	March	17th	(Cont.) The Bn marched to MAUREPAS where they were billeted in tents — company Officers and Head Quarters in huts. Lt J.H. Nash rejoined the Bn from 7th Gds Entrenching Bn.	
		18th	The day was spent in resting and cleaning up. Lt C.H Sheans rejoined the Bn from Lewis gun course at LE TOUQUET. and Lt T.R. Dames-Longworth from 4th Army School Lt W.C. MUMFORD M.C. returned to duty.	
		19th	General routine in Camp.	
		20th	Left Camp about 4.30pm and marched by companies to the Fregicourt area. The Bn was distributed as last time. Taking over from the 2nd COLDSTREAM GUARDS	
		21st	Bn took over from the 2nd COLDSTREAM GUARDS, thereby coming into Support — Bn HQ. went to the NEBULE. No 2 & 4 Coys in the QUARRY (NEBULE) No 1 in old BRITISH FRONT LINE at SAILLISEL and No 3 Coy at BULLET CROSS ROADS.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st B.n Irish Guards. (8)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	MARCH	1917.	Marched from support positions to the outpost line, taking over from the 2nd B.n COLDSTREAM GUARDS. Relief completed by 5 pm. The 4 companies were in the outpost line, and numbered 1–4 from right to left finding their own supports, Picquets, and fronts. The B.n front stretched from MANANCOURT — LE MESNIL en ARROUAISE. B.n H.Q was about U 10 a 3.8 in BULGAR TRENCH, which was a deep German dugout.	
18th			Fine weather but cold and windy. No artillery or rifle fire. Relief from our 3 right Corps — no 1, 2 and 3 were relieved in the outpost line by 12th B.n K.R.R. No 4 company was relieved by the 12th B.n R.B. Relief complete by 4.30 pm. The B.n by companies marched to COMBLES, where tents were erected for the men, the officers in dug-outs which were old Div.-art.: H.Q. The B.n H.Q at the TÊTE de BOEUF in COMBLES. No casualties this tour.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn Irish Guards. (9)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
COMBLES	March 1917. 19th to 31st		The Bn, to the end of the month remained in COMBLES. The whole Bn was employed on road making between FREGICOURT & BULLET CROSS ROAD and from this point to SAILLISEL. Six hours work being done per diem — work commencing at 12 noon. Major G.E.S. Young who was badly wounded on the 15th inst, died from the effect of his wounds in hospital on the 31st and was buried in the cemetry at GROVETOWN on 1st April. The weather throughout the month has been cold and stormy, with a few fine days. The total casualties for the month have been. Officers. W— MAJOR G.E.S. YOUNG. w 15/3/17 died 31/3/17 Lt. W.C MUMFORD M.C. w. 15/3/17 returned to duty 16/3/17 O.R. Killed 14. Wounded 30. N.R. Alexander Lt Col. commanding 1st Bn Irish Guards	

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April 1917 — Army Form C. 2118.

1st Bn. Irish Guards.

Vol 33

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
COMBLES	1-IV-17		The Battn was still in camp at COMBLES and employed on repairing roads between FRÉGICOURT and SAILLY-SAILLISEL. The funeral of MAJOR YOUNG took place at 3.30 p.m. at No 34 Casualty Clearing Station (ALBERT combined sheet F.25.d) Several officers from the 1st & 2nd Battns attending. Capt R.R.C Baggalley rejoined Battn H.Q as 2nd in Cmd. LT MUMFORD. relieving command of No 1 Coy	
COMBLES	2/4/17 to 5/4/17.		The Battn still remained in camp & continued work on the roads as mentioned above, being complimented by the C.R.E. for their good work. A number of dead bodies of Germans & French were dug up by the working parties and various articles such as field glasses, watches, bayonets etc found. With the exception of the 5th there was snow and rain or hail every day & the weather was exceptionally cold. On 3rd inst Capt. R.R.C. Baggalley was attached to 2nd Battn during the absence of the C.O. & 2nd in Cmd.	
LE TRANSLOY	6/4/17.		The Battn moved to LE TRANSLOY pitching a camp at the S.E. end of the village (O.24.a.5.6 ALBERT Combined Sheet). The ground was good but wet from the continual bad weather & rain & snow with exceptionally cold wind fell again during the day. The ground E. of the BAPAUME RD. was good	

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Army Form C. 2118.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LE TRANSLOY			having been little shelled. Captain R.R.C. Baggallay was granted temp. rank of Major while 2ⁿᵈ in Cmd of the Battⁿ	
			Battⁿ H.Q was established in a much damaged house (practically the only house standing) - Nos 1 + 2 Coys in a marquee + Nos 3 + 4 Coys in a ruined house. The pioneers did good work on the house.	
	7 4/17		During this period the Battⁿ worked on the broad gauge railway track	
LE TRANSLOY.			between MORVAL and ROCQUIGNY. With the exception of Easter Day snow & hail fell on each day although there were occasional sunny intervals. Weather was v. cold with hard frosts at night. A proportion of new clothing was issued	
	to		to the men the bulk of whose uniforms were in a very bad state from the Division having been so continuously in the line or in camps + from the work on the roads + railway tracks. The men found ample material	
	14 4/17		in LE TRANSLOY for improving the camps + flooring the tents while a good many tents had stoves found among the ruins. A magnificent Irish Gds star was made by No 3 Company of glass + stones + planted round by a low Box hedge. On 8th inst. Major R. Baggallay returned from the 2ⁿᵈ Battⁿ	
			During the work on the railway it was found possible to lean in camps some of the "Specialists" for training + occasionally a company	

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Army Form C. 2118.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
BRONFAY	15 4/17	9.45 am	The Batty marched to BRONFAY CAMP No 15 in pouring rain – distance 12 miles. The ~~Batty~~ were billetted in ~~Kisson~~ French huts.	
BRONFAY	16 4/17 to 22 4/17		During this period a very strict course of platoon training for all ranks was undertaken. The normal programme being Breakfasts at 7.30 am before which men did about 20 mins. walking + running. Batty parades at 8.30 am + Companies marched off independently to train according to the programme rendered the day before by Company Commanders. With the exception of ½ hours interval the whole morning until 12.30 pm. was spent in various forms of training. An hours work was done in the afternoons. The above was supplimented by lectures. From 16th inst to 21st rain fell each day ~~interfering~~ and somewhat hampered the smartness of drill as the ground was so slippery + muddy, but even after 3 days there was an appreciable improvement in drill + smartness. ~~There was a lecture on Outposts by the Brigadier to all officers + platoon commanders in the Brigade.~~	

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Army Form C. 2118.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
BRONFAY	16 4/17		On Sunday 22nd the Brigadier inspected the camp and ~~decided~~ complimented the 1st Batt Irish Guards on their smartness & cleanliness.	
	to 23 4/17		(Continued)	
do.	23 4/17		A lecture was given by the Commanding officer to all officers & platoon Sgts of the Brigade on Advanced & Rear Guards.	
	25 4/17		A lecture was given by the Brigadier to all officers & platoon Sgts in the Brigade on Outposts	
do	26 4/17		The Brigadier inspected the Transport of the Brigade and the Batt was complimented on the horses & wagons. ~~Batt here proved to be looking the best~~. Six pipers joined with draft.	
	27 4/17		A lecture was given by Officer Commanding 2nd Batt Coldstream Guards to all officers & platoon Sgts in the Brigade on "The attack in open warfare"	
do	28 4/17.		Platoon training came to an end. The Commanding Officer party by selection & party by Competition chose the best platoon in the Batt to compete for the Brigade platoon Competition. After great difficulty in selecting it	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
BRONFAY	28/4/17		it was finally decided that No 5 Platoon (LT. E. BUDD) should represent the Battalion. As Each Company also have difficulty in Selecting their Platoon it showed that the training of the platoons throughout the Batt^{n} was very level. The Platoons had to Compete in Drill and Arms Drill, Musketry - Bayonet Fighting and a Tactical Exercise	
do.	29/4/17.		During this Sunday No 5 platoon spent some time in further Musketry and Bayonet Fighting practice	
MAUREPAS	30/4/17.	3.15 pm	At 3.15 pm the Batt^{n} marched to MAUREPAS (5½ miles) where it was billeted in NISSEN HUTS for the night "en route" for ÉTRICOURT. No 5 Platoon was left behind with the Brigade H-Q & other units of the Brigade to continue with the platoon Competition	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
			OFFICERS JOINED.	
			2/Lieut H.V. FANSHAWE 30-3-17	
			Lieut. J. BUTLER-STONEY 18-IV-17 from Div. Works Batt^n.	
			COURSES of INSTRUCTION	
			Lieut. J.H. NASH G.H.Q LEWIS GUN SCHOOL (LE TOUQUET) 3-IV-17 to 18-IV-17	
			2/LT. D.A.B. MOODIE XIV^th Corps LEWIS GUN SCHOOL (MÉAULT) 16-IV-17 to 26-IV-17	
			H.R. Alexander Lt Col Commanding 1st Bn Irish Guards	

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May 1917
1st Bn. Irish Guards.
Vol 31

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MAUREPAS & ÉTRICOURT	1 5/17	9.45 am	The Battalion marched off at 9.45 am for ÉTRICOURT halting at BULLOT Cross Roads for dinners at 11.30 am (Sheet 57c U 19 & 9.9) & proceeded thence across Country to ÉTRICOURT. Total distance 7½ miles. The transport had to go round via ROCQUINY & MESNIL-EN-ARROUAISE. The camp was pitched beside the Canal (V 8 & 2.8) & Batt. H.Q & the Company officers messes established in the village among the ruins. The day was clondless & very hot.	
ÉTRICOURT	2 5/17		Work was commenced on the railway. Each day was clondless & very hot. The result of the platoon Competition was published. The 2nd Batt. Grenadiers were 1st and the 1st Batt. Irish Guards a very good 2nd thus being a much bigger margin between 2nd & 3rd than between 1st & 2nd Considering the difficulty in chosing the best platoon to represent the Batt. the result was v. Satisfactory.	
do.	4 5/17		On the 4th the Major General visited the camp and on the same day the pipers in their kilts played at Retreat for the first time. The Major-General who had inspected them during the afternoon expressed his satisfaction at their	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
ÉTRICOURT	4 5/17.		appearance + playing.	
	5 5/17		The Battalion remained in same camp + continued work on the railway bringing it up to EQUANCOURT and so on to FINS.	
	to		During this period a certain amount of training was managed in the shape of tactical exercises for Officers + N.C.O. as well as lessons in	
do	19 5/17.		map reading - sketching - reports and compass work. Sometimes a Composite platoon was made up of Officers + N.C.O. from each Company and a small tactical exercise worked out. The weather was mostly hot and fine. Magnificent Irish Guard stars were made at Each Company mess as well as at Batt^n H.Q and in the camp.	
do	20 5/17	8.am	The Batt^n marched to CURLU + was billeted there for the night in huts Companies marched at 500 yds interval via MANNANCOURT, MOISLAINS ∧ HAUTE ALLAINE and CLÉRY. An hours halt for dinner was made at 10.50 a.m. The weather was very hot and the march made somewhat tiring by a Brigade of Artillery using the same road at the same time.	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
CURZU	20/5/17.		The men were allowed to bathe in the Somme after arrival in camp. Total distance of march was 13 miles.	
MORLANCOURT	21/5/17	9.30am.	The Battalion marched via MARICOURT, BRONFAY FARM - BRAY to MORLANCOURT - distance 12 miles. Companies marched at 600 yds interval. Started in very heavy rain which continued until 10.30 am when the weather came out v. hot & sunny. No man fell out during the whole march. An hours halt was made for dinners at 10.50 am. On arrival at MORLANCOURT the Battn was billeted in houses in the village. The whole village was found in a filthy condition by previous troops.	
do	22/5/17.		The day was spent in cleaning up billets & in their neighbourhood. A large drill & training ground was selected just outside the village.	
do.	23/5/17.		Companies were placed at Company Commanders disposal for training. Further cleaning up of billets was carried out. The Brigadier visited the Battn A lecture & demonstration of putting gas helmets on horses was given by the Divisional Gas officer to the Transport.	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MORLAN COURT	24 5/17		Training of Companies continued with half an hours running & walking exercise daily before breakfast.	
do	25			
	29 5/17		Companies in turn carried out a Brigade scheme of a trench to trench attack. Companies (two at a time) went with their cookers down to the Somme to Gattle.	
MORLAN COURT	30 5/17		The Batt[n] less No 4 Company entrained at EDGEHILL SIDING (DERNANCOURT) at 7 pm. The Batt[n] less 1 company marched from MORLAN COURT at 5.30 pm via MÉAULT and DERNANCOURT to entrain. The train left at 7.30 pm proceeded via AMIENS, ABBEVILLE, BOULOGNE, ST OMER to CASSEL where	
	31 5/17		the Batt[n] detrained at 8.30 a.m. After breakfast the Batt[n] marched at 10.15 am along main ~~road~~ to ST OMER road to billets which were alongside the main road between LA CROSSE & railway crossing FORT ROUGE. (map 5[A] HAZEBROUCK). No 4 Company which remained behind as there was only room on the train for 3 Corps H.Q & Transport Grenadiers remained for the night 30th at MORLAN COURT and entrained at EDGEHILL at 3 pm 31st & detrained CASSEL 3.30 am & marched to rejoin Batt[n]	
LA CROSSE (RENESCURE AREA).				

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices

The following officers joined the Batt^{n} during the month of May.

Lieut. W. JOYCE for duty 3-5-17.

2/Lieut E.H. DOWLER do do.

2/Lieut A.L. WELLS do 13-5-17

Major C.E.A.S. ROCKE for duty & to Command 24-5-17

Lieut. R.B.S. REFORD rejoined from 4th Army Infantry School 2-5-17.

Courses.

Lieut H.H. MAXWELL proceeded to XIVth Corps School for Lewis Gun Course 11-5-17. Rejoined on 21-5-17

C.A. Rocke Major
1st Batt^{n} Irish Guards.

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or
~~INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY~~

(Erase heading not required.)

June 1917.

1st Bn. Irish Guards.

Vol 3

(1)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LA CROSSE	1 VI 17		The Battalion remained in same billets. Owing to all the surrounding country being under cultivation it was impossible to find good training ground. The forest of CLAIRMARAIS was apportioned to the various units in the Brigade and training in wood fighting carried out also training in musketry - bomb throwing etc. Lectures were given in billets and each Company in turn spent a morning at Arm drill under the Battn Staff Major.	
	5 VI 17			
LA CROSSE	6 VI 17		A Brigade Horse show was held at RENESCURE. The Battn entered for Best turned out limber & pair - Maltese cart & pair - Cooker & pair. The Battn was awarded 1st prize for Limber & pair & 2nd prize in each of the other two events.	
LA CROSSE.	7 VI 17 to 11 VI 17		The Battn remained in billets & continued training.	

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1st Bn Irish Guards.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MORINGHEM	12 VI 17	10.am	The Batt^{n} marched to MORINGHEM for musketry. The route followed was ARQUES - LONGUENESS - TATINGHEM - ZUDAUSQUES - MORINGHEM. Distance 13 miles in very hot sun. Batt^{n} H.Q was billeted at MORINGHEM with No 3 Coy. No 1 Coy at GRAND DIFQUES - No 2 Coy. at PETIT DIFQUES. No 4 Coy at BARBINGHEM. Batt^{n} arrived MORINGHEM 3.30 p.m. Two men fell out from heat stroke.	
MORINGHEM	13 VI 17		Firing commenced on the ranges at 6. am. all coys fired at one having 4 targets allotted to each coy. Practices carried out were 5 rounds at 200 yds slow & 10 rounds rapid at same distance, then 5 rounds slow and 10 rounds rapid at 300 yds. Firing ceased at 4. p.m. Dinners were taken on the range which was situated 1 mile W. of CORMETTE.	
LA CROSSE	14 VI 17		Firing on ranges commenced again at 6. am. Practices carried out were 5 rounds slow & 10 rounds rapid with fixed bayonets at 200 yds. Also Snapshooting at figures at same ranges. Firing ceased about 1. am & the men had dinner & marched back to billets at LA CROSSE at 3. pm	

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(3)

1st Bn Irish Guards

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LACROSSE	June 15th		A gymkana was held during the afternoon: Brig. Gen. R.C. McClintock D.S.O. and Major Hon. M.G. Chichester were present and dined with Bn. H.Q. The day was fine and the sports were a great success.	
OUDEZEELE	16th		At 7.20 am the Bn. moved from LACROSSE and marched to OUDEZEELE via LE NIEPPE — ZUYT PEENE — HARDIFORT. Owing to the heat of the day the men were given an hour & a half's halt at 11 am when they had their dinners. Arrived in at OUDEZEELE at 1.30 pm. Several men collapsed from the heat on arrival in billets.	
PROVEN	17th		At 8. AM the Bn. moved via WENEZEELE — WATOU to PROVEN, arriving in at 12.45 pm. The whole Bn was bivouaced in tents and shelters in the woods just S.E. of Proven and about ¼ mile from the town. Another very hot day.	
	18th		Remained bivouaced until the 25th. Specialists training was carried out in the wood, but owing to the cultivation of the country, training was limited.	
	19th			
	20th		On 20th Lt. N. Hickie, arrived from England and again took over his duties as Quartermaster. Lt. J.A. Nash to Central Army training School.	

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(4)

1st Bn Irish Guards.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
PROVEN.	June. 21st		The weather, owing to thunderstorms, became colder, and heavy rain fell during this week.	
	22nd		On 22nd Captain R Rodakowski went to attend the Coy. Comdrs Course at Lewis Gun School, LE TOUQUET.	
	23rd		On same day Lt W Joyce went to attend C of Instr at Lewis Gun School at LE TOUQUET.	
	24th		On Sat. the 23rd Major General Sir A Godley commanding the N.Z. Corps came over to see the 1st Bn and inspected the men who served with him in peace time.	
	25th		At 10 am the Bn moved to new bivouacs, about 1 mile W of WOESTEN. There were no tents, but small canvas shelters erected in the woods.	
WOESTEN AREA.	26th		Fatigues were found from here for working on railways and unloading trucks, which again prevented any training.	
	27th		In this area, the Germans fired during the nights with a naval gun, and although no damage was done, shells fell in the fields near the Bn	
			Enemy aircraft also very busy, bringing down one observation balloon in flames, about 1000 yds from our encampment.	

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1st Bn Irish Guards.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
ROUSSEL FM	June 28th		The Bn moved at 2 pm and marched 2 miles S.E to Camp at ROUSSEL FARM. 2500 yds W of ELVERDINGHE. This camp consists of long wooden huts, a large farmhouse and buildings which contained about 3 coys. the remainder bivouacked in canvas shelters.	
	29th		During the night the camp has been shelled by a 4.1 in gun.	
	30th		On the night of the 29th the enemy got 3 direct hits on the FM house, killing one man and wounding 3 others. (including Capt Whelan) On the 30th Capt R. Rodakowski returned from Lewis Gun School.	
			Weather during the last week has been thundery and stormy.	

J.H.R. Alexander major
Commanding 1st Bn Irish Guards

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1/G July 1917

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1st Bn Irish Gds.

WW 36

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
ROUSSEL FARM (B.13.a.25.70) ELVERDINGHE sheet 28.N.W.1	1/7/17		The Batt^{n} remained in camp at ROUSSEL FARM.	
	2/7/17			
TRENCHES BOESINGHE SECTOR	3/7/17		The Batt^{n} relieved the 2nd B^{n} Coldstream Guards in the X Line (ST JULIEN SA B.12.c.20.00 – B.11.d.–B.11.a.60.55) Nos 1 + 3 Coys with Nos 2 + 4 Coys in PARADOU R ROGER FARMS about B.10.c.30.70) and B^{n} H.Q at BLUET FM (ELVERDINGHE 28 N.W.1. Square B.10.c.35.35) between 9.30 pm and 11 pm. There was a little shelling.	
ditto	4/7/17		Batt^{n} in line as above. Early in morning LT. E. SHEARS was killed by shell and LT. T. BUTLER-STONEY was wounded by shell fire in X line at junction with BELGIAN ARMY on our left. Except for intermittent shelling the day was quiet.	
ditto	5/7/17		About 2 am a quantity of gas shells fired from projectors arrived on X line in the middle of a working party of No 4 Coy. Nineteen men were affected by the gas immediately + later including LT. BAGENAL (slightly). One man died at once & 2 men from the effects 2 days later. Intermittent shelling during remainder of day.	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
TRENCHES BOESINGHE SECTOR.	6/7/17		Quiet day. Major Hon. H.R. ALEXANDER D.S.O. M.C. left for England to attend Commanding officers Course ALDERSHOT. Capt. R.R.C. BAGGALLAY M.C. took over command. Gas alarm during night but no gas arrived.	
ditto	7/7/17		Little shelling. B^{n} was relieved by 3rd B^{n} Coldstream Guards at dusk, and the whole B^{n} was in huts & Grivonces by midnight at CARDOEN FM. (map 28 N.W.1. A 18. b. 20. 70)	
CARDOEN FARM.	8/7/17		Batt^{n} remained in camp. No shelling. LT. Col. C.A. ROCKE arrived back from leave. Carrying party of 110 men was provided from the Batt^{n} at dark to front line	
ditto	9/7/17		Batt^{n} remained in camp. No shelling. Carrying party of 110 men provided from the B^{n} at dark to front line.	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
TRENCHES BOESINGHE SECTOR.	10/7/17	2 pm.	Relieved the 2nd Bn Coldstream Gds in the trenches. Nos 4 & 2 Coys took over front line trenches along the Canal Bank from B.12.d.85.8 to B.5.d.75.80 (Ref map St Julien 1/10,000) No 3 Coy was in 'S' line about 200 yds in rear, running through ruins of BOESINGHE village in front of the Château - No 1 Coy in 'Y' line running in rear of 'S' line. Relief complete. The Batt'n moved off by Companies with intervals commencing at 2. p.m. Batt'n H.Q were at CHASSEUR FARM.	
ditto.	11/7/17		About 9. am. the Commanding officer (Lt. Col. C.A. Rocke) while going round the trenches fell down & broke his shoulder & was evacuated Capt R.R.C. BAGGALLAY. M.C. (2nd/Cmd) took over command. Intermittent shelling during the day particularly at BOESINGHE CHATEAU where were the AID POST & H.Q of No 1 Coy - and on the 'S' Line. No 3 Coy H.Q in 'S' Line were wrecked by a direct hit during the afternoon & Capt. T. MACMAHON. M.C. moved his Coy H.Q to the CHÂTEAU. During the night the enemy shelled a good deal the 'S' line - also for half an hour (11.30 pm to midnight) Batt'n H.Q. The Battn retired Behind canal	15/7/17

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
TRENCHES BOESINGHE SECTOR.	12/1/17		The work being carried out by the Batt^{n} consists of making assembly Trenches in rear of front line along Canal Bank. During day time most of Nos 1 & 3 Coy were employed helping Front Coys with this work. The front line was also the safest place for troops in day time. As it was impossible to dig at all owing to marshy nature of the ground the Trenches were made almost entirely by Sandbags which made the work rather slow & laborious. There was the usual shelling on S. line and BOESINGHE & again on Batt^{n} H.Q. On the whole this shelling was heavier than on previous 2 days. During the night
ditto			No 3 Coy were employed carrying ammunition, stores etc. from BOESINGHE CHATEAU up to prepare dumps in front line. Five dumps were filled.
ditto			The transport bringing rations & water was heavily shelled at WHITE HOPE CORNER (Ref map B.10.d. 50.60) The 4 C.Q.M.S. were wounded, mess Sgt. wounded, one horse & groom killed. The transport Officer (Capt P.H ANTROBUS) going back from Batt^{n} H.Q about 11. p.m. was slightly gassed by gas shells.

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TRENCHES BOESINGHE SECTOR.	12/7		At 11 p.m. the left front line Coy (No 2 Coy) was relieved by 1st Battn GRENADIER GUARDS and moved back into 'X' line (just in front of CHASSEUR FARM. The left of No 3 Coy was relieved in 'S' line and No 1 Coy in 'Y' line. The Battn was then distributed as follows. No 4 Coy still in front line. No 2 Coy in 'X' line. No 3 Coy 2 platoons in 'S' line and one in WAAL KRANTZ Trench + one at PARADOU FARM. No 1 Coy 2 platoons 'Y' line and 2 platoons at PARADOU FARM. The Dividing line between Battns in front system was roughly a line running along road running N.W. from BOESINGHE CHATEAU through square B. 12. a. (St JULIEN 1/10,000)	
ditto				
ditto.	13/7/17		The day passed quietly except for the usual shelling round BOESINGHE 'S' 'Y' + 'X' lines + CHASSEUR FARM. The remaining 5 dumps were filled by carrying parties formed as on the previous night.	

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TRENCHES BOESINGHE SECTOR	14 7/12	1.50 A.M.	The enemy at 1.50 am. opened a 'block' barrage on the 2 right platoons of the front line company and on the left platoon. The barrage consisted of French mortars - 77 m.m shells - machine guns. At the same time a heavy shrapnel and 77 m.m. barrage was put down on the support lines and WAAL KRANTZ Trench. This continued w its intensity until 2.30 am. The left centre platoon of front line Coy was not so heavily barraged. About 2.30 am. 10 Germans attempted to raid our front Coy. making their attack about B.12.6.20.55. The night was v. dark and the noise of the barrage v. great. Three Germans appeared on the parapet opposite the left platoon & disappeared again down the bank on being fired at. The line was lightly held owing to the length of front allotted being 800 yds. The Germans were seen crossing by a Lewis Gun post in a covered emplacement approached by a tunnel from front line. The emplacement being almost in the bed of the canal. The Germans were heavily fired on straight down the bed of the canal by this Lewis Gun & also along the opposite bank by Lewis Guns on our parapet & by rifle fire. It is estimated that	
ditto				
ditto.				

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TRENCHES BOESINGHE SECTOR	14 I 17		a number of casualties must have been inflicted on the enemy but the thick vegetation made it very hard to see any bodies lying about. Five Germans appeared on the parapet just to the left of railway and though fired on succeeded in entering the trench between two sentry groups or firing bays. Apparently LT. EYRE was coming along this trench alone & it is thought he ran into this party who captured him. His steel helmet & revolver with all chambers fired was found near the spot.	
ditto.			One German was captured wounded. This man had no identification on him & his pockets were empty (except for new & complete iron rations (an unusual thing to carry in a raid). He stated he belonged to the Rgt. SCHLESWIGS and that it was intended to raid with 200 men. It is doubtful if the enemy intended crossing over so many though large numbers were seen in the bed of the Canal & on the opposite bank. The enemy eventually retired. Our casualties in	
ditto.			front line were 1 offr & one man missing & one man wounded, though more casualties were sustained by men of R.E. & T.M.B. in the line & our Coys in Support lines from the Carriages.	

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HERTZEELE TRAINING AREA.	16/7/17		The Batt^{n} was at Company Commanders disposal. The Commanding Officer attended a Conference at Brigade H.Q. on the Coming operations. The Company Commanders went over the Training ground to study the trenches - farms etc marked on it to represent ground to be attacked over in coming operations.	
ditto	17/7/17		Major R.V. POLLOK from 2nd Battalion Irish Guards took over Command of the Batt^{n}. Officers & N.C.O. went over Training ground.	
ditto	R/7/17 to 23/7/17		The mornings were spent in drill - smoke helmet drill. musketry - firing - Lewis Gun drill etc. The afternoons in going over the Training ground & practising attacks & various schemes. The weather was hot and fine.	
FOREST AREA.	24/7/17		The Batt^{n} made rendezvous on Training ground at 9.15 am to take part in Scheme against 2nd Bn^{t} Grenadier Gds & 2nd Bn^{t} Coldstream Gdrs. Dinners were at 1 pm and buses arrived at Training ground at 3 pm to convey Batt^{n} to PROVEN where they marched to FOREST AREA at A.4.c.1.1. (map sheet 28. N.W.)	

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TRENCHES BOESINGHE SECTOR	14/1/17		During the day the situation was quiet except for the usual shelling which was rather more intense the last 2 days than at the Commencement of the tour in the trenches. At dusk the 1st Bn Coldstream Gds commenced to relieve the Batt[n]. At 9. p.m a heavy barrage was put down by the enemy on 3rd line and 4th line and WAAL KRANTZ trench. After 20 mins. of the barrage our artillery replied with a heavy barrage on the enemy front line and support lines. The enemy after about 10 mins of our barrage ceased his fire and fired no more except at about 11. p.m when they shelled the 4th line and in neighbourhood of CHASSEUR FM (Batt[n] H.Q). All the Companies with exception of No 4 Coy caught a train at 1. am (15/1/17) from ~~PROVEN~~. ELVERDINGHE Siding for PROVEN. The relief was carried out in heavy rain.	
TRENCHES to HERTZEELE AREA.	15/1/17		No 4 Coy & Batt[n] H.Q arrived at ELVERDINGHE siding about 2. 30 am and about 3. 30 am entrained for PROVEN from thence they marched to a farm at E.11. (Sheet 27 1/40.000) and joined the rest of the Batt[n]. AT 12. 50 pm the Batt[n] marched via MILITARY RD & HOUTKERQUE to the HERTZEEL area, arriving about 3. 30 pm. The billets were very scattered.	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
FOREST AREA.	25/7/17		At 2. am. gas alarm sounded from the front. but nothing more followed. Heavy rain commenced at 8.30 am & continued all the morning. The Bk provided working parties amounting to 515 men during the day & night carrying material & to front line system. Ten men were killed by shell fire and 1 offr & 7 men wounded during the work.	
CAMP A.12.d	26/7/17		Batt[n] moved up to Camp in Square A.12.d. marching by platoons at 200 yds interval starting at 5.30. p.m. Distance about 2½ miles.	
ditto	27/7/17		Remained in camp all day. News was received about 5 pm that no Germans could be seen by aeroplanes in German front line system & that the 3rd Batt[n] Coldstream Gds were sending patrols across canal.	
CAMP A.12.d to TRENCHES FRONT LINE BOESINGHE SECTOR.	28/7/17	1.am	At 1.am. orders were received to send 2 Coys to BLUET FARM. Nos 1 & 2 Coy were sent. About 8. am a message was received that a German wireless message had been intercepted stating a counter attack was to take place against a point where 3rd Bn Coldstream Guards (who were established in posts across the canal & beyond the German BABOON SUPPORT TRENCH) joined on with the 38th Div. on their right.	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
BOESINGHE SECTOR TRENCHES	28/1/17	10 AM	AT 10 a.m. the 2 Coys at BLUET FARM were ordered to go forward to the 'X' line under Capt R. BAGGALLAY M.C. who was at Bde H.Q at the time. The 2 Coys were to be under direct orders of the Brigade H.Q and in close liaison with 3rd Bn Coldstream Guards. Subsequently the order was changed to only one Company to go forward and No 2 Coy was detailed. AT about 12.30 pm this order was received that the whole Battn would move up and relieve the left of the 3rd Battn Coldstream Gds in the Outpost line. The relief commenced	
	6 pm		at 6 p.m. and the Outpost line taken over from DOUTEUSE HOUSE to pond B.6.b. Central, to S. of BOIS FARM to B.6.a.9.9 (approx) where touch was established with the FRENCH. Distribution as follows:- No 4 Coy (Capt. LAWS M.C) from DOUTEUSE HOUSE to pond B.6.b Central with 2 platoons in front line posts and a platoon in Support along line of BABOON SUPPORT (approx). No 3 Coy (LT. E BUDD M.C) from left of No 4 Coy to junction with French with 2 platoons in front posts and 2 platoons in Support along line of BABOON SUPPORT (approx). Two platoons of No 2 Coy (Capt. R. RASMUSSEN) E. of Canal in old GERMAN front line and 2 platoons in our old front line on Canal bank. No 1 Coy in 'X' line (Capt W.C. MUMFORD M.C) Battn H.Q + aid post at BOESINGHE CHATEAU.	

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Front line Posts BOESINGHE SECTOR	28/7/17		Between 6 pm & 7 pm the X line and BOESINGHE CHATEAU were barraged, and although there was almost continuous intermittent shelling the whole night barrages were put down on BOESINGHE CHATEAU, Canal Bank, S & X line from 9.45 pm to 10.45 pm. A good many gas & lachrymatory shells were fired & also included in the barrages. Six casualties occurred from gas shells ~~among~~ chiefly among Signallers and orderlies. Practically no wire was put out by the front Coys as none was available on the spot and the R.E. bringing up wire were held up by the barrage & only arrived at dawn.	
ditto	29/7/17	2 am	The left Coy sent out a patrol at 2 am to reconnoitre a Concrete blockhouse held by the Germans — which our artillery stated they were unable to destroy. Position of blockhouse B.6.b.20.50. They were fired on and a wounded prisoner captured ~~earlier~~ later stated the garrison was 1 M.G. & 20 men. Patrol proceeded on to BLUE line and found it held by small posts.	
		4.30 am	Patrol went out from approx. B.6.b.10.40 to reconnoitre Blockhouse. Fired at again and one N.C.O & 1 man wounded. Patrol wounded & captured 1 prisoner. Blockhouse kept under ~~Supervision~~ observation.	

(A7092). Wt. W12839/M1293. 750,000. 1/17. D. D. & L., Ltd. Forms/C.2118/14.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

Army Form C. 2118.

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
FRONT LINE POSTS BOESINGHE SECTOR	20/7/17		Patrol from ½ Right Coy went out and followed French Tramway B.6.b 30/20 + crossed road about B.6.b. 90/75 + followed French along E Edge of WOOD 15 and turned right handed about U.25.c.0.0. Patrol got within about 50 yds of junction of this French and CARIBOU Trench. Saw party of 20 Germans apparently doing ordinary French repairs.	
		10.30 am.	About 10.30 am. Small parties of men from the left Coy were posted by 2/Lt BUDDLE in such a manner as to completely observe the BLOCK HOUSE. They could see some of the enemy lying in shell holes round it. From the way our men have placed it was impossible for the Germans to take cover except by lying quite flat in holes. They were 'sniped' by our men + 2 or 3 hit. Two got up to run away + were shot down. The remainder then surrendered including those in the BLOCK HOUSE which was not large enough to hold all the garrison + reserves later then lying outside as stated above. Fourteen prisoners were taken and the BLOCK HOUSE occupied + consolidated, and held against the enemy's fire.	
			Subsequently the outpost line was advanced in line with the BLOCK HOUSE.	

(A7094). Wt. W12839/M1293. 750,000. 1/17. D. D. & L., Ltd. Forms/C.2118/14.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
~~Front~~ line trenches BOESINGHE SECTOR		12 noon	From 12 noon to 1 p.m. the enemy who had been shelling intermittently put down a heavy barrage on BOESINGHE CHATEAU & neighbourhood scoring one or two direct hits. The shells used during all the shellings being 5.9 and 4.2 and 77 m.m.	
		6 pm.	Guides were sent at 6 p.m for the relief. The Batt[n] was relieved by 1st GREN. GDS & WELSH GDS and returned to FOREST AREA Camp Area 1.	
FOREST AREA Camp area 1.	30/7/17.		This was 'Y' day for the attack. The Batt[n] remained in camp all day & at 10.30 p.m. marched by Infantry Track No 11 to Bivouac at their assembly ~~place~~ in a field adjoining CARDOEN FARM.	
IN BATTLE	31/7/17	6.20 am	'Z' day. Zero hour 3.50 am. Batt[n] moved from ~~the~~ place of assembly at 6.20 am. having had breakfasts at 5.15 a.m. Before moving off several high velocity gun shells fell in and round the field. B[n] arrived at forming up position at 8 AM. B[n] H.Q in dug outs at CHASSEUR FARM. Nos 1 & 3 Coys in 'X' line just in rear - Nos 2 & 4 Coy round JOYEUSE FARM. Stayed in these positions all day in spite of message from GUARDS DIV at 3.15 p.m ordering B[n] to be ready to move at ½ hours notice which order held come through 1st GDS. B[DE] H.Q.	

(A7092). Wt. W12839/M1293. 750,000. 1/17. D. D. & L., Ltd. Forms/C.2118/14.

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
In BATTLE	31/7/17.		The Bn was shelled intermittently during the day but few Casualties were sustained. Capt. F.S. LAW M.C. was slightly wounded.	

———— o ————

MAJOR. HON. A.C. CHICHESTER — D.A.A.G. 7th Div. 8-7-17

MAJOR HON. H.R. ALEXANDER D.S.O. M.C. — To Course of Instruction for Senior offrs. ALDERSHOT 7-7-17.

LIEUT. E. H. SHEARS — Killed in action 4-7-17.

" T. BUTLER-STONEY — Wounded " 4-7-17.

" H.B. BAGENAL — Wounded (gas) 6-7-17. To Hospital 9-7-17

LT. COL. C.E.A.S. ROCKE — Hosp. (accidentally injured) 11-7-17

CAPT. P.H. ANTROBUS — Wounded gas 12-7-17. To hospital 14-7-17. Rtd 17-7-17

LT. H.J.B. EYRE — Missing. Believed P. of W. 14-7-17

LT. T.R. DAMES-LONGWORTH — Hospital 15-7-17

LT. H.H. MAXWELL — Wounded in action 26-7-17. Died, 2-8-17.

2/LT. R.L. DAGGER. — Wd. in action 29-7-17

OFFICERS JOINED.

2/LT. R.L. DAGGER — Joined Bn for duty 9-7-17

MAJOR. R.V. POLLOK — Joined Bn on transfer from 2nd Bn I.G. to command 17-7-17

LT. J.H. NASH. — Rejoined on completion of Course of Instr. at 2nd ARMY SCHOOL WISQUES 26-7-17

COURSES

2nd/LT. A.L. BAIN — attd to No 9 Sqdn R.F.C. for instruction in shooting aeroplanes 9-7-17 to 12-7-17

(A7092). Wt. W12539/M1293. 750,000. 1/17. D. D. & L., Ltd. Forms/C.2118/14.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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August 1917 Vol 37

1ST BN IRISH GUARDS

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
In Action	1/8/17	12.45 pm	Received movement order at 12.45 p.m. to take over the lines held by 3rd GRENADIER GDS & 1st COLDSTREAM GDS in Support in depth in BLUE, BLACK & GREEN lines (see map attached. ~~1/10,000 SCALE~~). The Bn moved off at 3.30 p.m. in the order Nos 2. 1. 3. 4. Coys in column of platoons, Crossing the canal at PONT DE BOSSINGHE and following track by DOUTEUSE HOUSE to their positions in shell holes S. of HEY WOOD, with the exception of No 4 Coy which went straight to their positions in the BLUE LINE. The remaining Coys waited until 8 pm. During this period there was no shelling on the companies. No 3 Coy took over the ABRI WOOD - GRANDE BARRIERS. Hs. line; No 1 Coy the Right Support with 2 platoons in the GREEN LINE and 2 platoons 150 yds in rear. No 2 Coy. the LEFT SUPPORT with 3 platoons in the GREEN LINE and 1 platoon 150 yds in rear. Bn H.Q in GRANDE BARRIERE HOUSE (German Concrete Blockhouse). The H.Q of Nos 1.2 & 3 Coys were in German Concrete blockhouses. The ~~Brig~~ Bn AID POST was with No 3 Coys H.Q. at N.W. Corner of ABRI WOOD. Rain which had commenced at 6 pm the previous day fell heavily all this day and the ground was becoming exceedingly deep and wet.	OPERATION MAP is ATTACHED

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Army Form C. 2118.

(2)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
IN ACTION	1/8/17	6.pm.	At 6.pm message was received from 113th Bde 38th Div. on our immediate right saying that they were falling back on the GREEN line having been shelled out of the GREEN DOTTED line. It was at once decided to form a defensive flank. No 1 Coy sent 2 rear platoons & ahead to form a defensive flank along the railway (Div. boundary) joining up with the 2nd Bn GRENADIER GDS in GREEN DOTTED line. No 3 Coy moved their 2 left platoons to replace the 2 of No 1 Coy and No 4 Coy moved up 2 platoons to replace No 3 Coys platoons. The 113th Bde eventually went back to the GREEN DOTTED line at dark. Rain fell heavily all through the night. Shelling was not very severe.	
In action	2/8/17		In spite of the 113th Bde having moved back to their original position it was deemed wise to keep our defensive flank, as that Bde. continued to send up the S.O.S. signal at intervals. Rain fell heavily all day & conditions were becoming Exceedingly Trying.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

(3)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
In action	2/3/17	7 pm	At 7 pm. the 1st Bn Scots Gds relieved No 4 Coy = (2 platoons) in the BLUE LINE with a whole company. The remaining companies were	OPERATION MAP.
		8 pm	not able to relieve till 8 pm owing to the light. No 3 Coy was next relieved and then Nos 1 & 2 Coys in the GREEN LINE. On being relieved the Bn relieved the 2nd Bn Grenadier Gds in GREEN DOTTED LINE. No 2 Coy took over the left front - No 3 Coy took over the right front. No 4 Coy in Left Support and No 1 Coy in right Support leaving 1 platoon on the railway forming a defensive flank. Relief was complete at 1 a.m. The relief was delayed by an S. O. S. Signal being sent up by 38th Div. on our immediate right which brought a barrage down & necessitated every body "Standing to". The S. O. S was a false alarm & no action was taken by the Enemy. There was heavy shelling all throught the night & ceaseless rain. After relief Bn H.Q were established at CAPTAINS FARM in an old 4.2 gun pit. The remains of the gun were still there.	

(A7092). Wt. W12839/M1893. 750,000. 1/17. D. D. & L., Ltd. Forms/C.2118/14.

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
IN ACTION	3/8/17.		The day was very misty and rain was still falling heavily. Orders for relief were received - the B[n] relieving us being the 1st B[n] SCOTS GUARDS. The relief commenced at 8.30 pm, and the companies were relieved in the order No 2. 3. 4. 1 Coys. On completion of relief the B[n] marched back by platoons to ELVERDINGHE siding. On the way the men received hot tea - chocolate Cigarettes - biscuits in as large quantities as they liked at a Soup kitchen organised by the Division. The benefit the men received from this and the manner in which it was organised cannot be too highly praised. The march from the line was exceedingly difficult in the dark and the mud + water in the shell holes + the rough ground being beyond all description. The companies finally formed up at ELVERDINGE railway siding and entrained in trucks, leaving at 4.50 am. for BANDAGEM railway siding. (Sheet 27	
POLL HILL CAMP.	4/8/17	4.50 am. 6. am.	About 6. am. B[n] detrained at BANDAGEM siding. The B[n] details which had remained in bivouac in FOREST AREA No 1 moved to POLL HILL CAMP the previous afternoon.	

(A7092). Wt. W12838/M1293. 750,000. 1/17. D. D. & L., Ltd. Forms/C.2118/14.

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
POLL HILL CAMP (Sheet 27 N.E. E 10 A	1917 Aug 5th to Aug 18th		Refitting and Training. Training was very limited, owing to all the ground in the neighbourhood being under cultivation. The corn in most of the fields was still standing, owing to the recent wet weather. Steady drill; drill with small box respirators, rapid wiring and specialist training, were carried out daily. Route marches by Companies, once a week. The camp is situated near a farm and the Battalion is accommodated in Tents, bivouacs & a barn. The weather up till Aug 15th was very wet. A draft of 1 Officer (2 LT. G.P. BOYD) and 100 other ranks joined the Bn. on Aug. On these dates a) Aug 8th & Aug 14th. A working party of 250 other ranks was furnished by the Bn for work on BOESINGHE BRIDGE & DOUTELSE HOUSE RD. These parties were taken by train to BRANDHOEK siding from PROVEN SIDING at 8am to ELVERDINGHE SIDING returning in the evening by same route. On Aug 14th MAJOR R.R.C BAGGALLAY, who was in command of the party, was slightly wounded. Aug 11th LT. THE HON.BLE D.J OGILVY joined the Bn. and assumed command of No1 Coy vice LT (ACT CAPT) W.C MUMFORD appointed TOWN MAJOR of ELVERDINGHE LT. E BUDD assumed command of No 4 Coy vice LT (ACT CAPT) H.A.S LAW (wounded).	

(A7092). Wt. W12839/M1293. 750,000. 1/17. D. D. & L., Ltd. Forms/C.2118/14.

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
POLL HILL CAMP —	1917 Augs 5th to Aug 18th		Aug 15th Orders were received that we might expect orders to be ready to move at one hours notice on following day. Aug 16th about 10 am we received orders that we would not be required to move. About 11 am A bombing accident occurred, resulting in the wounding of 13 other ranks, none of these casualties were very serious. Every precaution seems to have been taken to see that there were no live bombs amongst the dummy ones, which were being used for practice but a live one got mixed up with the dummies and caused the accident. Owing to the improved weather conditions and the cutting of more crops, we were able to practice the normal attack formations by companies on a fairly suitable piece of ground, on Aug 17th.	
	Aug 19th to 26th		Training underwent a slight change, so as to counter the latest GERMAN method of defence ie the holding of no definite line and relying on a defensive system of small posts, carefully screened from all observation (air + ground). The chief innovations were more practice in surprise situations, during the attack — a slower moving barrage, to enable the surprise situations to be dealt with + to give time for the line to reform behind the barrage, after having dealt with the situations. On Aug 19th marched to HERZEELE TRAINING area and practised a Battalion attack. Weather conditions during past week continued favourable.	

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Place	Date 1917	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
POLL HILL CAMP E10A 54	Aug 27 Aug 28		Aug 27th Brigadier General Jeffreys C.M.G., Commanding 1st Guards Brigade presented medal ribbons to the undermentioned, in front of the Battalion, which was drawn up in MASS LT E BUDD. Bar to M.C - Sgt (Act C.S.M) P DONOHOE (No 3056) - No 1910 Sgt (a/C.S.M) F McCUSKER No 3224 Cpl E. McCULLAGH - No 4133 L'CPL J. VANSTONE - No 7520 Pte S NULTY - No 5279 Pte S ROCHFORD (Bar to Military Medal) No 10171 L'Cpl S. McHALE Military medals No 10161 L'Cpl W COOPER. D.C.M. The following NCO's & men were unable to be present on parade, but were awarded honours during the past month. No 4512 Sgt. BALFE J. - No 3146 L'CPL. COYNE F - No 4386 Sgt. MAC DONALD J - No 6078 Pte MARTIN J Military Medal No 4864 Pte O'BRIEN D. Croix de Guerre.	
DULWICH CAMP ELVERDINGHE AREA	Aug 29th 30th 31st		Left POLL HILL CAMP at 1.15 pm and marched to PROVEN SIDING, entrained for ELVERDINGHE at 3pm. On arrival marched to DULWICH CAMP ( ) close by siding. Camp consists of Tents & bivouacs it is rather exposed and liable to long range shell fire. Furnished 2 Working Parties for R.E in forward area, early morning of 31st. 1 Party 2 Officers & 100 O.R burying cable, the other party 1 Officer & 50 O.R making Artillery Track.	

(A7092). Wt. W12839/M1293. 750,000. 1/17. D. D. & L., Ltd. Forms/C.2118/14.

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
DULWICH CAMP B 9 C 6.0.	1917 Aug 31st		On night of 31st furnished 2 Working Parties for R.E. One of 2 Officers and 100 O.R. Carrying material. One of 1 Officer + 50 O.R. making of Artillery track in fwd area	
			Strength of Bn on 31st July 1917 — 26 Officers and 1002 O.R.	
			Joined during past month — 5 —— and 189 ——	
			Casualties during month — 2 —— and 125 ——	
			Present strength Aug 31st 1917 — 29 —— and 1066 O.R.	
			Owing to exposed position of camp. Nos 1 & 2 Coys moved into camp vacated by 2nd COLDSTREAM, so as to have men more scattered.	

A. V. Pollok Lt Col
Commdg 1st Bn Irish Guards.

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
DULWICH CAMP B9C 60 ELVERDINGHE AREA	1917 Sept 1 to 4		1st GUARDS BRIGADE were BRIGADE in Support to 3rd GUARDS BRIGADE in the line. The Battalion furnished about 400 to 450 men per night for working and carrying parties under RE in the forward area. The Bn were very lucky as regards casualties except on night of Sept 3/4, when 2 LT. G.P. BOYD & 4 men were killed and 23 others wounded.	
RUGBY CAMP B10C 88 BLUET FARM AREA	5th to 8th		Relief of 3rd GUARDS BRIGADE by 1st GUARDS Bde commenced on night of Sept 4/5. The Bn. moved to RUGBY CAMP in relief of 4th GRENADIERS and became Bn in reserve to 2nd COLDSTREAM and 2nd GRENADIERS in front line. The 1st COLDSTREAM replaced up in DULWICH CAMP. During our stay in this camp ~~had~~ we had fairly quiet time, and only had to find from 50 to 100 men per night, to work in forward area, on Bde. fatigue. On evening of 8th we came on "one hours notice" to move to GREEN LINE in accordance with the defence scheme. The GREEN LINE (vide Map attached) is not dug. It is wired & held by M.G's only. The defences will only be garrisoned in cases of emergency.	

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(2)

Place	Date 1917	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
IN ACTION RT BN DIVISIONAL FRONT	Sept 9th to		Marched from RUGBY CAMP at 7.45 pm on evening of 9th. The 1st GDS BRIGADE held the divisional front from STADEN RAILWAY at U.17 C.9.2 on Right to U 15.b.5.5. The BN: relieved the 2nd GRENADIERS in the RIGHT SECTOR from STADEN RAILWAY on right to U 16 d 05 80 The Bn was disposed as under in front line & Support On RIGHT No 1 Coy. In Centre No 3 Coy. On LEFT No 2 Coy. In Reserve No 4 Coy The line consisted of a line Posts in shell holes. The shell holes being improved only just sufficiently, to make them habitable. This was done with ~~has~~ a view to making the posts as inconspicuous as possible, to enemy observers on ground and in the air. (For exact positions of posts and method of holding line see attached ~~Map~~ map) The gendes non 2nd GRENADIERS met us at BOIS FM on the DUCKBOARD TRACK known as BRIDGE ST. The men carried two days rations. The water was sent forward by the DECAUVILLE RY to the terminus on the WIDJENDRIFT RD. Companies marched in in the order No 3.1.2.4. As the last ~~one~~ 2 companies were arriving at the	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
			the railhead, to pick up their water. The enemy put down a very heavy barrage, which continued for about an hour & a half. This considerably delayed the relief and caused the Bn about 27 casualties. Relief was eventually complete about 1 am on 10/9/17.	
LINE	10th		About 2 30 am a party of Germans 8 strong, who had lost their way, were rounded up & captured after a little fight, resulting in 3 Germans being wounded. This party was captured by the 1st and platoons of No 3 Coy (2nd LT CORRY D.C.M). The enemy shelled us heavily from 3 am till 5 30 am. During our tour in the trenches Enemy aircraft were very active, especially in the evenings flying very low over our front line and firing at the men in the trenches No casualties were caused	
			During night of 10/11 One German deserter came over to No 1 Coy. Officers patrols were sent out to reconnoitre BEAR SUPPORT and all ground on our side of BROMBEEK, no trace of enemy could be found this side of BROMBEEK. The ground here is very marshy. The nearest	

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(14)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
# LINE	1917 Sept 11th		enemy post that could be located in FRONT of the RIGHT COY was to S.E of STADEN RY about U 17 d 4 6. Our artillery very active during day. Enemy artillery activity below normal. Between 1 & 2pm enemy artillery carried out a shoot on the PILL BOXES occupied by the RIGHT COY. During night Sept 11/12 38th DIVISION which was on our RIGHT was relieved by 20th DIV. Enemy artillery very active from 3 am till 5.45 am. Enemy infantry very active last night in front of LEFT BN.	
	12th		LEFT COY established new post at U 16 d 10 65, so as to improve communication with LEFT BN. and to prevent enemy getting round our left flank through WOOD 16 Central. Enemy infantry unusually active during night Sept 12/13. Several parties were seen and dispersed by our rifle fire. A double trip wire was laid in front of our posts N of BRONBEEK and joining up with RIGHT POST of LEFT COY. A certain amount of wiring was also done by RIGHT COY. Night Sept 12/13 considerable enemy activity observed at dusk, especially in wood 16 Central. At 2 45 A.M. enemy opened heavy barrage & attacked LEFT BN. Barrage continued till 5 30 am. Wiring was continued during night.	

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(5)

Place	Date 1917 Sept.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LINE	13th		A quiet day. During night 13/14 were relieved by 1st SCOTS GUARDS. Relief was over an hour late at RENDEZVOUS nr BOIS END. Night was very dark and there was very little shelling. Relief was very much delayed owing to two parties getting lost. One through the guide being killed, the other through guide losing himself. Relief was not complete till 2.30 am. The Bn. entrained at LUNAVILLE FM for ONDANK SIDING about 4 am. From ONDANK DUMP Bn marched to CARIBOO CAMP near DE WIPPE CABARET. One PLATOON of NO 2 COY & BN HQ missed the train & had to march to CAMP. Bn was not complete in new camp till 7.30 am. Commanding Officer (LT COL R.W. POLLOK) proceeded on leave. CAPT. A.F.L. GORDON assumed command. The Bn was occupied on TRAINING. (Bayonet Fighting, Steady drill. Drill with small box respirators erection of huts, Sandbagging etc.) during their stay in this camp. The CAMP is not out of reach of shell fire & the facilities for training were not very good. The camp consisted of BELGIAN HUTS.	
CARIBOO CAMP A11d	14th to 19th			
POLL HILL. PROVEN AREA E10a	20th		The Bn marched to CAMP via INTERNATIONAL CORNER ST SIXTE	

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The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

Instructions regarding War Diaries and Intelligence Summaries are contained in F. S. Regs., Part II. and the Staff Manual respectively. Title pages will be prepared in manuscript.

WAR DIARY
or
INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.

(*Erase heading not required.*)

Army Form C. 2118.

(6)

Place	Date 1917	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	Sept 20th 6.30a		R. PROVEN. Bn left camp at 8.50 am and arrived at new camp at 1 P.M. New Camp consist of 2 or 3 barns Bell tents + shelters. The Bn: was employed TRAINING Special features PLATOON and COMPANY training. Attack practice, alteration of methods, so as to deal with new method of defence adopted by enemy (DEFENCE of organised shell holes, arranged in depth) Specialist Training. Route Marches + Recreational training On 20th Our details from the GUARD ~~BRIGADE~~ DIVISIONAL REINFORCEMENT BN which was formed at HERZEELE in July last returned. Strength 4 Officers and 118 other ranks On 21st Br: GEN: G.D JEFFREYS C.M.G saw the BN on parade and said good bye to us, on his promotion to command 19th DIVISION. LT COL C.R.C de CRESPIGNY assumed command of 1st GUARDS BRIGADE On 27th Commanding Officer (LT COL R.V. POLLOK) returned from leave and ~~re~~ assumed command. On 29th LT.R.B. REFORD who has been assistant Adjutant for some time, assumed command of No 3 Coy.	

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(*Erase heading not required.*)

Army Form C. 2118.

(7)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
			vice Capt T.F MAC MAHON wounded in action on 11.9.17. The company in the meantime had been commanded by LT. N.B. BAGENAL.	
			Casualties during past month.	
			2nd LT G.P. BOYD wounded in action 3.9.17 died of wounds same date.	
			CAPT. T.F. MAC MAHON wounded in action 11.9.17.	
			2nd LT J.S.V STONEY joined BN for duty 25.9.17	
			Reinforcements joined during past month 1 Officer + 146 O.R.	
			Casualties 1 Officer died of wounds: 1 Officer wounded: 14 O.R.	
			Killed in action - 78 O.R. wounded.	
			Strength of Bn: 28 Officers 1091 O.R. on Sept 30th	
			Honours received during past month	
			No 4884 Pte D. O'BRIEN awarded CROIX de GUERRE for gallantry & devotion to duty between July 31st & Aug 3rd. 5279 PTE. J. ROCHFORD awarded D.C.M. for gallantry, devotion to duty and organising ability, when employed as a stretcher bearer with a working party on Sept 3rd	

2/Lt Sollitt H. GR
Commd 1st Bn
1st R. Irish Guards
30.9.17.

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